You Get What You Give

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Not Rated

Archive Warning:
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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Octavia (She-Ra), Mermista (She-Ra), Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Lonnie (She-Ra), Rogelio (She-Ra), Kyle (She-Ra), Angella (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra)

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by masternoveller

Summary

Adora spends one week at Horde Enterprises - a construction company.
She's paired up with the labourer, a magicat called Catra.
And since the supervisor is never there, she ends up shadowing the magicat.
Opening her eyes to the shoddy work environment and work practices at H.E.

Or

Loosely based on undercover boss - very loosely (no one is in disguise).

Notes

I spent way too long on this fic not to post it... so here it is. Enjoy.

See the end of the work for more notes

“Welcome aboard Miss Gray.” Shadow Weaver welcomes Adora to the workshop floor of Horde Enterprises, a construction company that took on the erection of large buildings, skyscrapers and whatever crazy whims the head honcho of the organization desires to pursue, the tall, dark and scary woman with a red mask and long black hair and looks around and sighs, “Where is she?”

“Who?” Adora whips her head around, the end of her blonde ponytail hitting her in the face a little as she tries to see what Shadow Weaver is looking at or for.

“That worthless magicat.” The tall, dark and scary woman (TDSW for short) says, “Catra.”

“Oh, okay…” Adora furrows her brow confused at both the attitude of her new manager and whoever she’s talking about, “And… who is Catra?”

“The labourer.” Shadow Weaver says the word with such distain it makes Adora’s teeth grit, “Completely unreliable in my opinion, I don’t know why we keep her on.”

“Uh…” Adora replies confused with the entire situation and then the sound of a motorcycle pulling up has the blonde snapping out of her thoughts as she looks around to see who could that be.

“There you are.” Shadow Weaver crosses her arms over her chest and it looks like she’s glaring at the newcomer through her mask, “You’re late.”

“You told me to meet you on site. Not the workshop.” The helmeted newcomer replies begrudgingly before taking off said helmet to reveal a magicat underneath, “Not my fault.”

“I had clearly said to meet here. It’s not my fault you are incompetent.” Shadow Weaver replies cooly, “Now, enough of this insolence. I have a new team member that’s here to shadow you, this, is Adora.”

“Hi, I’m Adora.” The blonde turns, holding her hand out with a smile, “It’s nice to meet and work with you.”

Catra looks at the extended hand in front of her and twitches her nose, Adora’s brain automatically goes to *oh my stars, she’s so cute!* as the magicat takes her hand and shakes it firmly, rasping out a greeting of her own, “Hey, Adora.”

“Hi!” Adora grins as the magicat pulls her hand back from the blonde.

The magicat turns back to Shadow Weaver, “Why am I getting a shadow?”

“Because you obviously need one.” The TDSW replies in disdain, “Perhaps she probably will usurp you like so many others have already done.”

“If you’re trying to get me to quit…” Catra starts to argue when she’s interrupted by Shadow Weaver’s question.

“Where is your vehicle, Catra?” Shadow Weaver sighs out as she looks to Catra’s motorbike, “That contraption is not suitable for the job that you do.”

“You took my vehicle away.” Catra replies simply before adding, “Or did you forget?”

“What Hordak sees in you, is beyond me.” Shadow Weaver grunts out with a disappointment rolling in her tone, “If it was up to me…”

“Yeah, well it isn’t.” Catra quickly retorts, “So, can I go now?”

“Fine. Go.” Shadow Weaver waves her off, “Adora, did you drive here today?”

The blonde looks back nervously, “No. I thought I would be spending today here. In the workshop.”

“I’ve got a spare helmet.” Catra says looking the blonde up and down, “And a spare jacket around here somewhere.”

“No. I can drive her to site.” Shadow Weaver suggest instead.

“Oh, no. It’s fine.” Adora politely refuses the ride (and time spent alone with TDSW in a small and enclosed space with no escape…), “If it’s okay, I can just go with Catra. Since I’m shadowing her and all today.”

“Are you sure?” Shadow Weaver asks, Catra can tell she’s trying to remain cordial, “It’s no problem for me to drop you off and then pick up later on.”

Catra snorts out a laugh, “Since when have you offered anyone a ride?”

“I don’t know what you’re talking about.” Shadow Weaver feigns ignorance, “I have given many a person a lift when required.”

“Sure.” Catra says unbelievingly before turning to Adora, “Let me grab my spare jacket and helmet from Scorpia’s locker.”

“Thanks.” Adora replies, “But I think I’ll come with you, if that’s okay?”

The magicat shrugs, “Sure. I guess I’ve got some time to show you the lower dregs of this place.”

“Catra. What have I told you about calling the workshop that?” Shadow Weaver chastises and then turns back to Adora, “Are you sure I can’t give you a lift? It would be a lot safer in my car than on the back of that 2 wheeled death trap of a contraption.”

“Thank you for your offer, Ms Weaver, but I think I’ll be fine with Catra.” Adora once again politely declines with a smile.

“Come on, Adora.” Catra holds her hand out for the blonde, “It’s this way.”

Without a second though, Adora reaches for Catra's hand, instantly feeling a shiver in her spine at doing so the second time in the last few minutes as she tries to keep her cool, waving to Shadow Weaver, "It was nice to meet you!"

"Call me if you have any problems. It's on the email from our correspondence." Shadow Weaver says before turning around heading out of the workshop and towards the elevators.

Adora lets Catra drag her through the workshop 'dregs', the magicat pointing out a few things like toilets, certain offices, the kitchen etc until they reach a locker room, the magicat lets go of Adora's hand and vies straight for a locker clearly marked, SCORPIA, on it.

"Where's your locker?" Adora asks as Catra unlocks the locker and pulls the door open.

"Don't have one. It's apparently a privilege I don't deserve." Catra replies flatly as she grabs the jacket and helmet out and shuts the door with her elbow, "Here. They should fit."

"Thank you." Adora replies as she takes the items from Catra, putting the helmet down on the bench before slipping her arms into the biker jacket, "It's a little big, but it fits."

"Cool." Catra replies relocking the locker.

"Is this actually your spare jacket?" Adora enquires curiously, "Seems a lot bigger than you…"

"Yeah, it is." The magicat twitch as she replies, "It's the first one I got on my own coin. Just so happens to be a rare find in a thrift shop."

"And the helmet?" The blonde asks holding up the item.

“That I stole from another biker.” Catra grins and Adora’s eyes widen. The magicat starts to laugh, “I’m joking, princess. I didn’t steal it. I won it in a bike race way back. I bet the idiot that I could beat them in a race… around a BMX track. They agreed not realising there’s a reason why it’s a BMX track and not made for motorbikes. They crashed out after the first corner and I won the race easily.”

“And they just… gave you their helmet?” Adora quirks an eyebrow up at her, “That’s kind of gross.”

Catra grins, shaking her head, “Nah, the only person that’s ever sweated in that helmet, is yours truly.” Adora does an experimental sniff of the helmet and grimaces as Catra laughs again, “Look, I’ll get some antibacterial wipes for you, okay?”

“Thank you.” Adora smiles back as she watches Catra walk towards the exit, “Hey! Wait up!”

The magicat walks over to someone’s workspace and grabs a few wipes, taking the helmet out of Adora’s hands and wiping it down, “And yeah, they gave it to me because they weren’t bad people and they kept their word.”

“Oh, that’s nice.” Adora takes the helmet back and sniffs it again, smiling this time, “Thanks for doing that.”

“Least I can do.” Catra replies and then looks up at the time, “Alright, we need to get going before my foundation girl leaves without doing her job.”

“Are you sure this is safe?” Adora asks, now reconsidering getting that lift from Shadow Weaver as Catra swings her leg over and sits down comfortably, pulling her helmet on and then waiting for Adora.

“No.” Catra replies, “Nothing is 100% safe. But I’ll do my best to get us to site safely.”

“That’s reassuring…” Adora bites her lip as she takes a deep breath and then joins the magicat on the motorbike, happily surprised she’s got footpegs and even a small back rest to lean back on, her hands grab onto it as she breathes out, “Okay…”

“How’s the helmet?” Catra asks.

“It’s fine.” Adora replies playfully knocking it against the back of Catra’s and then chuckling to herself, “It also smells fine in here too.”

Catra starts up the bike but doesn’t move, the blonde still sitting back and waiting and then the magicat turns around and says, “You kind of have to grab onto me, Adora.”

“Why?” The blonde asks confused.

“Because you’re going to fall off if you don’t.” Catra shakes her head with a chuckle, “Lean forward and hold onto me, princess.”

Adora chuckles nervously and then leans forward, her hands hesitantly resting on the sides of Catra’s jacket, clearing her throat she asks, “Like this?”

The magicat grabs her hands, “Oh, I forgot something.”

“What?”

The magicat digs around in her jacket pockets and pulls out a pair of gloves, “Here. For your hands.”

“Oh, right.” Adora slips them on and then leans back forward again, grabbing onto Catra’s jacket once again and then yelps a little when the magicat grabs her hands to wraps around her lower abdomen and making the blonde’s front press onto her back, “Uh…”

“That’s better.” Catra says with a nod and then revs the engine, “Hold on.”

“Woah! Catra!” Adora nearly screams when Catra starts to build up speed, the blonde’s grip tightening around the magicat’s body the further they go away from the workshop and eventually the blonde gets used to the speed and relaxes a little, “…stars…”

“You good back there?” Catra shouts out over the noise.

“Yeah!” Adora replies loudly and finally enjoying her first ride on a motorcycle.

Catra pulls up to a construction site, parking up next to the small site office set up inside a fenced off lot, getting off and going straight to the door of the office, trying the door and only to find it locked.

“For fuck’s sakes…” Catra grumbles and looks around the empty worksite.

“What’s wrong?” Adora says as she stands next to the magicat.

“Octavia is supposed to be here already. She’s the supervisor.” Catra replies pinching the bridge of her nose and sighing, “She always does this.”

“Does what?”

“Not turn up when she’s supposed to. Especially on the big days, like today when we’ve got a concrete pour to do.” Catra reaches into her jacket pocket and pulls out a set of keys and opens up the site office, switching on the lights and then walks over to the lone computer in the office and switching it on, “H.E insist of getting everyone to sign in via QR codes on their sites, except they refuse to print them out to put on the walls and I don’t have access to any of that. So… paper sign ins it is.”

“Can’t you just call her? Or tell Ms Weaver she’s not here?” Adora asks.

“Weaver doesn’t care.” Catra takes a seat on the chair and starts typing away on the computer, “And Octavia isn’t going to answer her phone, not for me anyways.”

“Are there anymore people coming today?” Adora stands awkwardly, trying to look casually in the small office.

“No. I’ve got the foundation girl coming at around 10am to do the testing on the concrete we’re pouring today.” Catra says as she quickly reads through a few emails and then gets up, walking over to the folders sitting on the bench against the wall, “Okay, looks like you’re going to have to get your hands dirty today, princess.”

“Uh…”

“Yep, so sign in and then I’ll quickly do a quick toolbox with you and go through all the safety stuff and then grab you some gloves and a pair of gumboots.” Catra waves the blonde over to the open folder and taps the spot on the page for her to sign in.

“Okay, I think I’ve got everything.” Catra looks around at all the tools required for the concrete pour for the slab of the new building, “Now all we have to do it wait.”

The concrete pump truck already set up and ready to go as Catra walks over to talk to the lizardman with the controls strapped around his neck, he doesn’t talk but communicates with Catra with a series of hisses and grunts, something that the magicat seems to understand and be able to communicate with.

“It’s to see you Rog.” The lizard man grunts back in response as Catra grins, “Yeah, I know. But you know how it is, when Octavia is in charge, right?”

Another grunt and a hiss this time, the lizardman and Catra share a laugh as the magicat turns and points to Adora, waving for the blonde to come over, “Hey, Adora! Come meet Rogelio.” She grins

and then when Adora is closer enough says, “Rogelio, this is Adora. It’s her first day.”

He grunts again and holds out his hand, Adora quickly takes it and shakes his hand, “It’s nice to meet you, Rogelio.”

The sound of the first cement truck cuts off their introductions as the magicat waves the truck over, after a brief chat with the driver she comes back and looks at the pair, “Ready?”

“I can’t believe you fell into the concrete!” Catra cackles as she floats the still wet concrete, the foundation girl had collected her samples and left as Adora pouts, her clothes soaked after needing to get rinsed off after accidentally misstepping on the reo covered by the concrete as she tried to get the bubbles out of the mixture with the concrete vibrator, “I’ve got this, Adora. Go get changed.”

“Into what, exactly?” Adora huffs out unhappily, “I didn’t exactly bring a change of clothes on my first day.”

“Oh… shit.” Catra remembers and then has to think, “Well, you can either stand in the sun and dry off or ran across the street to get some new stuff. Just grab some cash from my jacket if you need to. I’ll be okay here for a bit.”

Adora looks up and the sky looks gloomy, cloudy and overcast but not enough for rain as she sighs, “I don’t think the sun is going to come out.”

Catra looks up as well, “Yeah, I guess not. Go grab a change of clothes.”

“Are you sure you’re going to okay here, all by yourself?” Adora asks genuinely concerned, “What happened to the whole… not working alone thing?”

“Well, you’re soaked and if you stay in those wet clothes you’re going to get sick, Adora.” Catra says whilst running the float over

the wet concrete, “Look, I’ll be fine. I promise not to fall in and die.”

“That’s not funny.” Adora says with a frown as Catra simply shrugs, “I can’t just leave you alone on site. What if something else happens?”

“Like?”

“I don’t know!” Adora groans out as she starts thinking of the imminent dangers that could be lurking around, “You could slip and fall and bump your head on the wooden boards around the concrete.”

“Formwork.” Catra corrects with a chuckle.

“Whatever.” Adora brushes that off, “Or you could get attacked by a mob of angry people.”

“Angry people?” Catra repeats amused, “What angry people?”

“Angry people from all the noise we’ve been making or when the trucks blocked the roads.” Adora says.

“Yeah, no. I already prewarned the businesses around here last week about today’s concrete pour.” Catra replies.

“What if someone breaks in and does bad things?” Adora brings up, “It could happen.”

Catra rolls her eyes with the same amused look on her face, “Fine. Give me about half an hour to finish this and then I’ll go with you.”

Adora seems to relax with that, nodding in acceptance, “Okay.”

“You’re a real pain in the ass, you know that?” Catra says light heartedly, “But, your worrying is warranted, I guess.”

“Do you get left alone a lot?” Adora asks as she watches the magicat continue to float the slab.

Catra nods, “Yeah, but I’m pretty sure that that’s because they think Octavia is here too.”

“But she’s not.” Adora points out the obvious.

“Nope. She sure isn’t.” Catra agrees.

“You should report her.” Adora says.

“I should.” Catra repeats, “But it’s gotten me nowhere in the past, so, I’ve stopped trying.”

“What? What about your safety rep?” Adora asks “Surely they should be all over this.”

“Nope.” Catra replies, “And don’t even bother bringing up HR. All they seem to care about is the fact that I’ve been written up internally more times than anyone else?”

“For what reason?” Adora frowns angrily.

“Insolence. Workmanship. Tardiness. Taking too long to complete tasks and costing the company money because of it. Take a pick.” Catra replies easily.

“If you’re being treated so poorly… why stay?” Adora asks, “I’ve only shadowed you for a day and you seem to be competent and knowledgeable. Also, you’re very capable considering you literally did this entire pour solo.”

“Why, thank you, Adora.” Catra replies with a shy grin and then jokes to cover the feeling the compliment hits her in the chest, “But I wasn’t solo. I had you and Rogelio. Call it a team effort.”

“That’s… no. That’s not the point.” Adora sighs, “Why stay? Why work for H.E?”

“I can’t get a recommendation to go anywhere else.” Catra replies flatly, her tone free of emotion, “And they aren’t going to give me one. Not mention I don’t have any certified qualifications.”

“Oh.” Adora says, “But the years of experience should quell that, shouldn’t it?”

Catra shakes her head, “It’s hard to put experience down if your bosses won’t confirm them with potential new employers.”

“But what about…” Adora starts and is cut off by Catra.

“It’s fine, Adora.” The magicat sighs, “I’ve found ways around getting jobs done. I know enough contractors to pull favours when I need to.”

And then Adora says something that stuns the magicat, “You could… you could just let it fail.”

Catra finishes of the area she’s floating and then takes the end bit off, “Can you rinse this off for me, please?”

“Sure.” Adora nods, coming over and taking the floating device from the magicat, “I’m already wet. Can’t get wetter.”

Catra turns her head, her mind definitely in the gutter as she holds back a snicker unsuccessfully making the blonde narrow her eyes at her and then rolling them, “What?”

“Keep that up and that’s sexual harassment, Cat.” Adora warns as she washes off the concrete off the tools.

“Won’t happen again.” Catra doesn’t even deny her thoughts, instead pushing them aside as she goes to take her gumboots off and then washes her hands once Adora is done with the tap, “Okay, now we have to let it set for about an hour and then I can do the next part.”

Adora nods as she stands the floats up to dry.

“Let me go grab my jacket and we’ll go get you a change of clothes.” Catra says walking off towards the site office.

“Catra! No. I can pay for my own stuff.” Adora protests as the magicat pulls out some cash from her pocket to pay for the new shirt and pants to replace the wet clothes the blonde is still wearing.

“Okay, you can pay for it.” Catra says as she holds the money in her hand and waits for the blonde.

Adora pats around her pockets and realises she has no wallet, or money, just her phone and then gets an idea, she looks at the middle aged woman ringing her up, “Do you take card?”

“Sorry, but our payment machines are on the fritz currently.” The cashier says and then points to the ‘CASH ONLY’ sign by the counter, “It’s been like that for a few days. We’ve got a new machine coming next week, hopefully.”

“Oh.” Adora looks at her phone and then back at the cashier before sighing and then proceeds to nudge the magicat, “Can I borrow some cash? I’ll pay you back.”

Catra chuckles and shakes her head, “Here.” She puts the cash into Adora’s hand, “Pay me back whenever.”

“Thank you.” Adora says sheepishly before handing the money over to the cashier who just looks on amused at the pair.

“Hey, Sal? Is there somewhere Adora can get changed out of her wet clothes and into her new ones?” Catra asks the cashier counting out the change and handing it back to Adora who then in turns holds it out to the magicat, “Thanks.”

Adora nods.

“She can get changed in the changerooms.” Sal replies, “Just show your receipt to Jen. I’ll let her know to expect you.”

“Thanks Sal.” Catra slips her some of the change back, only for it to be pushed back to her, “Touche.”

“You’re a good egg, Catra.” Sal simply says and then shoos them off to go to the changerooms to see Jen, then she leans towards Adora, “I’m amazed no one’s tied this one down yet.” And then winks at her, “Let me call Jen now.”

“Thanks again.” Catra laughs when she sees the slight ‘rabbit in the headlights’ look on Adora’s face and then the blush creeping up, “Come on, Adora. You’re going to get sick in those wet clothes and this aircon.”

“Oh, right. Right…” Adora comes back to the present, she doesn’t even feel the chill from the air conditioning, “Where are we going?”

“To go see Jen. Do you have your receipt?” Catra asks and the blonde looks around with wide eyes.

“No. Let me just…” Adora starts to turn around but the magicat quickly stops her mid-spin, “Catra. I need to go grab the receipt.”

“I got it right here.” Catra waves the docket in her hand, “You gave it to me with the change dumbass.”

“Hey! I am not a dumbass!” Adora shoves the magicat with a laugh and then she shivers as the cold finally hits her, “I need to get out of these soggy clothes. It’s getting really uncomfortable”

“This way, then.” Catra gestures for the blonde to follow her towards the changerooms.

The sun is starting to set when Catra finally finishes cleaning off the last of her tools when they finally head back to the site office,

her clothes damp from sweat and her shoulders slumped forward as she sits down at the lone computer once again, moving the mouse around to wake the device up before tapping on the keyboard.

Adora goes to the folder and picks up the pen, looking for at the magicat hunched over squinting at the screen, “You’re going to wreck your vision if you keep staring at the screen so closely.”

Catra mrrps, turning her head and nearly hitting her face against the screen in realisation that she’s not actually alone in the office, “Oh, hey. What are you still doing here?”

“What?” Adora says looking at the magicat incredulously, “What do you mean?”

“Your shift finished 3 hours ago.” Catra replies as she turns her head back to the screen and starts squinting again, “You can sign off and head on home, Adora. Thanks for your help today.”

“Uh… what?” Adora repeats this time somewhat irate.

“Sign off and go home.” Catra repeats in a tone that indicates she’s misunderstood Adora’s irate tone, “I’ll see you tomorrow. Or not. I’m not sure where Weaver’s got you going tomorrow.”

“I’m shadowing you all week.” Adora says as she pulls out her phone to check her emails to see if there’s any schedule changes, “It says to meet at the workshop every morning.”

“Okay.” Catra replies not listening.

There’s a moment of silence and the awkwardness of it only seems to be palpable to Adora whereas Catra doesn’t seem to notice at all, the blonde sighs out, “How long are you going to be?”

“Huh?”

“How long are you going to be?” Adora repeats a little slower.

“Uh…” Catra says dragging out the word as she’s still in the middle of reading whatever it is on the screen, “I… yeah.”

“Catra.” Adora calls out.

“Hm?” Catra doesn’t look up.

“Catra.” Adora tries again.

“Yeah?” The magicat still doesn’t look up.

“Catra!” Adora says in more than a whine.

“What?!” The magicat snaps her head to the blonde, unhappy at being taken away from what’s she’s doing before realising that she’s literally yelled at Adora, “Shit. I’m sorry. I didn’t mean to shout at you.”

Adora sighs as she walks over to the computer and stands in front of where Catra is seated and looks at the screen, “What are you doing?”

“Checking the schedule for tomorrow.” Catra replies as she sits back, so Adora can get a better look at the screen, “I’ve got a few things to do still.”

The blonde’s eyes widen in shock as she sees the amount of email in the magicat’s inbox, “I thought you were just the labourer. Why are you doing all of this?”

Catra laughs out cynically, “That’s my title. And I’m going to have less than that if I lose my job.”

“That’s not right.” Adora says as she furrows her brows as she looks at the subject lines of some of those emails, “Some of those look more like engineering questions. You’re not an engineer, are you?”

“No.”

“Then what are you doing with all those emails and by the look of it staffing ones too?” Adora probes a little more, “Should you even be looking after contractor correspondences that deal with their actual contracts? I bet your also not an accountant or legal or got anything related to business contracts.”

“Nope.” Catra throws her head back, “Look, it’s cute that you want to pull me out of all of this, but I need this job. So, if you don’t mind?”

Adora grits her teeth but sighs, stepping back and crossing her arms as she says, “I need a ride home.”

Catra pulls out her phone, “Do you want me to call someone to take you home?”

“No.” Adora shakes her head.

“Do you want to call a friend or someone to take you home?” Catra flips the question as she goes back to replying to emails and reading through reports.

“No.”

This time Catra looks up confused at the blonde, “What? Are you planning to walk?”

“No.”

“Okay…” Catra narrows her eyes at the blonde, “Then?”

“You’re going to take me home.” Adora declares, “In half an hour.”

“No, I’m not.” Catra shakes her head, “I’ve got heaps to do still.”

“Yes, you are.” Adora says, “This isn’t your responsibility.”

“Yes, it is.”

“No, it’s not.” Adora says, “I’m going to pull the plug on that computer whether you’ve finished or not.”

“No, you’re not.” Catra chuckles under her breathe, “Just… just call a ride or something, princess. You don’t have to worry about me. I can handle this. Been doing it for the last 2 years.”

“2 years?” Adora replies shocked.

“Yeah.” Catra leans forward and starts to type something out before checking her phone and then continues typing, “Pretty sure I’m the reason for most of these new contracts coming on board.”

“You?”

“Is that surprising?” Catra asks still not tearing her eyes away from the screen, “Think someone like me can’t do something like that?”

“No, that’s not what I…” Adora frowns, “I didn’t mean that. Not at all.”

“Then what do you mean?” Catra asks as she quickly peruses over a drawing for the site tomorrow for the other slabs that need to be made up as well as the location of the piles that still need to go in, under her breath she mumbles, “I’m going to need to get more tie wire…” and then groans out, “Fuck. I’m going to have to raid the workshop again.”

“Shouldn’t they be providing all the materials you need for the job?” Adora asks, “Surely there’s some sort of budget…”

“There is.” Catra replies, “But I don’t have a company credit card.”

“Who has one?”

“The supervisor.”

“The one that didn’t show up to work.” Adora points out and Catra nods, “No, this is ridiculous. You need to report this to Ms Weaver to deal with.”

"No." Catra says, "Which part of *it's not going to do any good,* not getting into that brain of yours? And for the love of the stars, do not tell her yourself. I've already got enough on my plate to have to deal with her too."

"But you can't keep doing this." Adora argues.

The magicat shrugs, "Look, I don't need both Octavia and Weaver breathing down my neck and micromanaging me on site at all times. Really, I don't."

Reluctantly giving in, Adora nods, "Fine. I won't tell Ms Weaver about your supervisor."

"Thank you." Catra replies nodding back.

"But I am going to text her about *me* going in tomorrow to pick the materials for you." Adora adds on and before quickly shutting down the magicat's protests, "No. She seems to like me. Albeit in a creepy sort of way… And I doubt she'll care if I grab material or not."

The magicat sighs, "Fine."

The blonde smiles back victoriously as she takes a seat on the edge of the desk that Catra's working on, the magicat spares her a quick glance before shaking her head and getting back to work.

"It's been half an hour. Finish up or I'm going to pull the plug." Adora warns.

The magicat looks up, "No, you won't."

"Yes, I will." Adora challenges standing up and moving to behind the computer, "Do you really want to test me?"

"No, you won't." Catra repeats not taking Adora seriously and then she sees the blonde reaching for the plug, "Hey! What are you

doing?!”

“I warned you.” Adora simply says as her hands goes to rest on the plug, “So, last chance before I pull the plug.”

“Ugh! Fine! Just… let me quickly save this and close out of the rest of my programs, okay?” Catra negotiates.

Adora rolls her eyes, “You have 2 mins. Starting from now.”

The magicat growls as she quickly finishes what she’s doing and closes down all the programs and then shuts down the computer, “There. Happy?”

“Yes. Very.” Adora smirks, walking over and putting on the bike jacket from earlier in the day and then throwing Catra’s hers, “Can we go now? It’s late and I’m hungry.”

Catra laughs as she shrugs on her jacket too, “Did you sign out?”

“Oh, shit, no. Hang on.” Adora signs herself out, “What about you?”

“I’m… no.” Catra replies.

“No?”

“Yeah, if they see my hours, they’re going to flip.” Catra replies as Adora defies her and signs her out too, “Hey!”

“Well, it wouldn’t make sense for me to sign out alone since I’m supposed to be shadowing you, does it?” Adora replies with a shrug, the logic a little too hard for Catra to dispute, “Okay, time to go.”

“Right.” Catra says somewhat defeated with the day as well as arguing with Adora, “So, where can I drop you off?”

“Can we get dinner?” Adora asks.

“Are you asking me to take you out, Adora?” Catra smirks tiredly and then adds, “Wouldn’t that be some kind of sexual harassment?”

“Not if I asked you to.” Adora rolls her eyes and nudges the magicat, “And yes, take me somewhere so we can get dinner. I haven’t eaten anything all day.”

Catra’s stomach grumbles, “Which direction are you in?”

“Back towards Mystacore.” Adora replies, “Why?”

“I know a good pizza place on the way there.” Catra says, “Come on. It’s getting late.”

After a rather uneventful dinner with little conversation, Catra drops Adora off in front of her apartment complex, turning off the engine and flipping the visor up on her helmet, “I guess I’ll see you tomorrow in the workshop.”

“Yes.” Adora confirms, “I’ll grab the tie wire first thing in the morning.”

“Do you need a lift?” Catra finds herself asking in her tired state, “Or have you got your own transport? Do you have a car?”

Adora shakes her head, “No, not currently.” The blonde bites her bottom lip feeling a little guilty at accepting the ride, “I can probably find my own way in tomorrow. I’m sure my friends wouldn’t mind dropping me off again.”

“I’ll come pick you up at 6am.” Catra yawns, “Can I grab your number?”

“You want my number?” Adora repeats slowly.

“Yeah, so I don’t have to yell up or beep my horn to let you know I’m here.” Catra says with a slow blink, clearly ready to go home

and straight to bed, “So?”

“Give me your number and then I’ll text you, so you’ll have mine.” Adora says instead and Catra nods as she rambles out her phone number while the blonde creates a new contact and sends a message to the magicat, the sound of a message tone rings out loudly in Catra’s pocket as she pulls it out and see’s a new message on it from a new number, “There.”

“Thanks.” Catra quickly saves Adora’s number and pockets her phone, “Have a good night, princess. I’ll see you in the morning.”

“You know… calling me that could be construed as a form of harassment too.” Adora points out and Catra’s eyes widen as she gulps down the feeling of making the blonde uncomfortable as Adora chuckles under her breath, “It’s fine, Catra. I don’t mind. But maybe next time ask me first.”

“Fuck. My apologies, Adora.” Catra looks away from the blonde sheepishly, “I’ll be more careful.”

“No, look, it’s fine. Just ask next time you start calling your coworkers nicknames.” Adora advises.

The magicat nods, “Uh, yeah. Sorry about that.”

Adora sighs, “You better get going, it’s getting late.”

“Okay.” Catra yawns as she slaps the visor back down, “I’ll see you tomorrow. Good work today, Adora.”

Suddenly feeling disappointed at not hearing the nickname anymore, Adora sighs, “Just ask me.”

“Ask you?” Catra asks, her voice muffled inside her helmet as she flips her visor up again, “Ask you what?”

“Just ask me if you can call me that nickname.” Adora replies all at one, trying to keep her voice steady, “It’s not harassment if I agree to it.”

A small smile appears on Catra's face, her mood suddenly lifting as well as her energy, "Can I call you princess, Adora?"

"Yes." Adora quickly replies her smile mirroring the magicat's, "Also just don't put those words together. People might get the wrong idea."

Catra laughs, actually laughs and for a long time feels like the weight of the world isn't on her shoulders as she nods, "Okay, I'll keep that in mind, princess."

"Oh! I forgot!" Adora digs out her keys, the magicat quirks an eyebrow up at her as she struggles to get her door open, "Let me just get some money to pay you back for my clothes and dinner!"

"Don't worry about it, Adora." Catra brushes it off, "Shout me tomorrow. You pick the meal."

"Are you sure?" Adora comes back towards Catra on her bike, "I can pay you back right now…"

"Yeah. Tomorrow is fine." Catra nods tiredly, "My bed is calling my name and I have to answer her call."

"Her call?" Adora tries not to sound jealous, but deep inside she may be a little green.

"My bed." Catra clarifies, "Just me and my bed."

"Oh, right." Adora laughs awkwardly, "Goodnight, Catra. See you tomorrow."

"Goodnight, Adora. Get some rest, I'll see you in a few hours." Catra closes her visor once more, Adora tapping the top of it playfully as the magicat laughs, turning her engine back on and starting up her bike, "Get inside, princess. I'm not leaving until your door is shut and your safely inside your home."

"Oh, okay." Adora nods and taps the top of Catra's helmet again as she walks back to her apartment, finally getting her door open

and going inside. And as soon as her door is shut, she hears Catra's bike start to take off down the street until she can't hear it anymore.

6am the next morning

Adora looks out her window, expecting to see Catra's motorbike when she gets the text from the magicat that she had already pulled up and parked outside her place. What she didn't expect is for the magicat to arrive in a white beat up ute.

She comes out after a moment to spot Catra wave at her from behind the wheel, the blonde waves back as she makes her way to the passenger door and opens it, "Hi, Catra."

"Hey, Adora." Catra greets back as she watches Adora get into the passenger's seat, "Hope you like coffee."

"Huh?" The magicat points down to the two takeaway cups in the cupholders in the middle of the console, "Oh, yeah. Thank you. What is it?"

"Coffee?" Catra asks confused, "Black."

"Oh…" Adora tries not to grimace.

Catra laughs, holding out something in her hands to Adora, "I like mine black. I wasn't sure about you but here, milk and sugar. Add it now before I start driving."

The blonde smiles back relieved, taking the lid off one of the cups and tipping the milk and sugar into the cup, "Thank you so much. I can't really do just black coffee."

"My stomach can't really stand dairy." Catra shrugs back in response as she watches Adora secure the lid back on and take a

sip, “Ready for work?”

“Ahh!” the blonde breathes out happily at getting a hot coffee in the morning, “Yes.”

“Great.” Catra puts the ute in gear and they take off towards the workshop, “How are you feeling?”

“I woke up a little sore honestly.” Adora admits, “I wasn’t expecting it to be so full on yesterday.”

“You’ll get used to it. Or not.” Catra chuckles, “Once your muscles get used to it. But then again, you’re only shadowing me for a week, right?”

“Yeah.” Adora nods in confirmation.

“And then… what happens after that?” Catra asks as she concentrates on the road ahead, “Is this like a trial week or something?”

“Sort of.” Adora replies, “I’m not sure what I’m doing next week.”

“Okay.” Catra nods, “Have they not told you or are you planning to go somewhere else…?”

“I’m not sure…” Adora starts to say, “I haven’t really decided yet what to do.”

“I bet you’re not going to stay as labourer.” Catra chuckles to herself, “You seem the kind to go to the top.”

“Why do you say that?” Adora turns her head to look at the magicat with curiosity on her face.

“You look like a leader.” The magicat shrugs as she says easily, “I can tell. I’ve seen enough people bypass me for leadership roles.”

“So… you’re basically saying I look like a leader because you’ve never been promoted?” Adora tries to clarify.

The magicat doesn't respond to that, instead turning on the radio and turning it up to drown out the rest of the conversation for the rest of the drive.

They arrive back at the same site as yesterday after picking up a few boxes of supplies from the workshop that Adora had managed to sweettalk out of Shadow Weaver – as long as Catra was no where to be seen, it seems like Adora had free reign to grab and get anything she needed or wanted as Shadow Weaver just left here after their brief exchange.

As Adora just finishes signing in the door to the site office swings open and a few people walk in, a small blonde haired man, a dark skinned woman and a familiar lizardman, "Uh… hello?"

The trio just stare back at the blonde as Catra's left ear twitches towards the door to indicate she's aware of their presence, "Sign in guys and then we'll get the toolbox done and go through the safety stuff and then we can get started."

The trio just nod and sign in before moving back outside the office as Adora stays inside waiting for Catra, "Should I wait out there too?"

"Nah, just give me a couple more minutes and we'll all head out to get started." Catra replies as she finishes whatever she's doing on the computer before standing up and stretching her arms over her head and then says with all the enthusiasm of someone facing the galley, "Ready for another awesome day?"

"Well at least you've got more help today." Adora tries to look at it like a glass half full.

"True." Catra nods and then pulls out a pair of gloves for Adora, "Here. You're going to need these today."

"Thanks." Adora takes them and tries them on as the magicat then holds out a pair of wire nippers, "What's that?"

"Nips."

"Excuse me?" Adora says incredulously, "What did you say?"

Catra realises what she's just said, "They're wire nippers. Or nips for short. Not whatever you're thinking."

"Oh. Right." Adora takes the strange pair of pliers and puts it in her back pocket before following Catra out to meet the others.

"Hey guys, this is Adora." Catra introduces the blonde, "Adora, these are Kyle, Lonnie and you already know Rogelio from yesterday. They're the best reo crew I've had in a very long time, even if Kyle screws up a lot."

Kyle grimaces and then waves to Adora sheepishly, "That's why I don't do the physical stuff…"

"He's the best reader of the drawings that we get from the engineers." Lonnie elaborates, "Means Catra here can concentrate on getting the right reo in place and spaced right."

Adora nods, having absolutely no idea what Lonnie is talking about at all.

"Come on, let's get started." Catra starts to walk towards the piles of steel laying bundled up before stopping in front of them and looking at Adora's non-steel cap feet, "Adora, stay where you are while we cut these free."

"What? Why?" Adora starts to protest and then holds up her pliers, "I've got these."

"Yeah, but you're not wearing safety boots." Catra points out.

"Neither are you." Adora throws back and Lonnie laughs out at the exchange.

"Yeah, Catra!" Lonnie joins in, "Where are *your* boots?"

“Shut up, Lon.” Catra grumbles out under the breath before she gets an idea, “Well, since the three of you have the right gear on and Rogelio is essentially indestructible, get snipping and sorting.”

“Aren’t we supposed to go through a safety talk first?” Adora brings up and the trio look at her.

The trio all grin, happy to delay the start of work as Catra rolls her eyes, “Fine. Have you guys all read the SWMS?”

“You mean that huge document in the folder?” Kyle asks awkwardly.

Catra groans knowing the answer is no, “Okay… I guess we’re going to have to go through that first before you idiots sign onto it and the pre-start document…”

“Lunch?” Lonnie asks as she wipes her brow with her sleeve, “I’m fucking starving, boss.”

Catra ears twitch at the word as she sighs, “Can we at least tie in the rest of this layer in first before we take lunch? We still need to weld in the cages as well as the hurdles.”

“Sure, boss.” Kyle squeaks out from where his reading the drawing, standing over the reo still laid out across the yard.

“Where’s your boss, boss?” Lonnie asks as Rogelio nudges her with his shoulder knowing that she’s just riling up the magicat, she grins back at him, “Have they promoted you yet?”

“Can we please not talk about this?” Catra grunts back.

Kyle turns to Adora who’s in the middle of tying in the bottom layer still, “Weaver purposely put Octavia in charge of Catra so she can redeploy her to other teams since they know that Catra basically runs most of these jobs single handedly.”

“I don’t run anything single handedly.” Catra refutes at Kyle.

“It’s exploitation at it’s worst.” Lonnie adds, “I bet we make the same amount as her even though she’s running this job.”

“Are you?” Adora asks as she straightens up to stretch her back from leaning over so much.

“No.” Catra replies for the dark skinned woman, “They don’t.”

Rogelio grunts out like he’s scoffing out as Lonnie shakes her head, “She probably makes like two bucks an hour more than us.”

“Still more from my calculations.” Catra says with a huff, “Can we get this done and then you three pain in my asses can leave me alone for an hour for lunch?”

The trio laugh, “Yeah, yeah.”

“Do you really only make two dollars more an hour than your crew?” Adora asks as she follows Catra back into the site office, “That doesn’t really seem fair.”

“Life’s not fair, princess.” Catra replies as she pulls out a bottle of water from the small bar fridge in the office, throwing another to Adora who catches it in her right hand.

Gulping down her water, the blonde takes her spot back on the edge of the desk as Catra wakes the computer and starts working, the blonde sighs, “Really?”

“What?” Catra replies as she clicks through a few emails.
The blonde pushes Catra back on her wheely computer chair, “No. It’s lunch time. You know, lunch?”

“I know lunch.” Catra replies, “I don’t do lunch.”

“No. We’re having lunch. My treat.” Adora declares and then adds, “I’m not taking no for an answer.”

“I’m not done yet.” Catra protests as she tries to get back to the computer only for Adora to stand between her and the desktop, “Adora. Seriously, I don’t have time.”

“And you won’t have time if you never make time to look after yourself.” Adora argues back, “Give me your keys. I’m taking you out for lunch. Your work will still be here when you get back.”

Catra sighs, but she really is hungry so it’s really not that hard to give in, “Fine. But only half an hour. I still need to get stuff done for tomorrow.”

“Forty-five minutes.” The blonde offers up instead.

“Thirty-five minutes.” Catra counters.

“Forty minutes. Final offer.” Adora shakes her head.

“Fine.” Catra rolls her eyes, “But I’m driving.”

“Fine.” Adora replies with faux disappointment.

“Welcome Adora.” A man in a black suit who appears to be a valet greets the blonde when she directs Catra to what appears to be a hotel, “Your table is ready. Head on in and I’ll park your… vehicle.”

“Thank you, Ellis.” Adora replies as she unbuckles her belt and then nudges Catra to do the same, “You can leave the keys in the ignition. They’ll bring it back when we’re done.”

“Uh… okay…” Catra unbuckles her seatbelt and then opens the door, “Try not to… uh, scratch her... more.”

Ellis nods, not even making any comments about the state of the vehicle with dents, scratches and mud covering it’s exterior. He

hands her a ticket, “Here you go. When you are done, just hand this to the attendant and we will fetch your vehicle for you.”

“Thanks.” Catra takes the ticket and pops it into her back pocket, yelping a little when Adora grabs her by the hand and tugs her inside, “Adora!” the magicat groans out quietly, “What are we doing here? We’re not even clean…”

“It’s fine, Catra.” Adora says without turning around until they get to the hostess and Catra is sure that they’ll get turned away, but she’s surprised when the hostess simply shows them to ‘Adora’s table’.

“Would you like still, sparkling or tap?” The waitress asks and Catra has no idea what she’s referring to.

“Tap is fine. Thank you, Penny.” Adora replies, “And could you bring my regular but times two?”

“No problems, Adora.” Penny replies with a soft smile, “I’ll be back with your waters.”

“Thanks.” Adora repeats and then smiles at Catra, the magicat looking back at her with peak uneasiness at being at such a fancy place, “Are you alright?”

“What are we doing here?” Catra whispers, trying not to draw any more attention to themselves, “I can’t afford any of this.”

“You’re not paying. It’s my treat, remember?” Adora rolls her eyes, “Just relax. No one is going to kick you out. I promise.”

Catra takes a deep breath and then nods, putting her trust in Adora and the furrows her brows, “Are you an actual princess? Princess?”

Adora snorts out a laugh, “No. Definitely not.”

“Then…?” Catra tries to get more information out of the blonde who shuffles a little nervously, “Not a princess… What are you

then?”

“A… regular?” Adora replies with a wry laugh as their entrees arrive, “Oh look! Food! Thank you so much!” Adora thanks the servers and starts to stuff her face with the small starters, actively ignoring the question.

“I’m going to find out, Adora.” Catra says with a confident look in her eyes, “I’m pretty good at figuring things out, princess.”

Adora just smiles mischievously back, “I know you are. But… can you keep a lid on it until the end of the week?”

“For you, princess? Sure.” Catra replies.

“Yeah?”

“I said I would, right?” Catra shrugs as she tries the starters and then adds, “And if I guess right…”

“I’ll give you a surprise.” Adora finishes for the magicat, “Eat up, we only have forty minutes.”

Catra nods and quickly devours her starters as Adora steers the conversation back to other ‘safer’ topics.

Catra looks at the time and glares playfully at the blonde, “Sneaky.”

“What did I do?” Adora feigns innocence.

“I’ve got ten minutes before the crew come back and we have to get back to work.” Catra replies knowingly, “You managed to steal an extra ten minutes…”

“Oops.” Adora grins, “But was it worth it?”

“Yes.” The magicat quickly replies before jumping back on the computer and going back to whatever she was doing prior to

Adora pulling her away, the blonde sighs out loudly making Catra's ear twitch, "Are you with me tomorrow?"

"Pretty sure I'm with you all week, Catra." Adora says, "Unless Ms Weaver changes my schedule."

"Right." The magicat replies, "Well, looks like we're going to be working on a different site tomorrow. We got a crane booked… apparently. Crane is going to be coming at 7am to lift up a bunch of steel beams that we're going to have to bolt in. Have you got a Working at Heights certificate?"

"No. I don't think I have that." Adora replies softly, "Why do I need one?"

"It's a harness up sort of job." Catra explains, "That's cool, I'll just see if I can get a second climber tomorrow." The magicat pulls out her phone and holds it up to her ear, "Hey, I need a second climber tomorrow to bash in some bolts on the new Hill Building downtown. You in? Awesome. You've got your gear still? Great. Crane's coming at 7am... yeah, meet up at 630am. See ya in the morning."

"That was quick." Adora points out, "Were they expecting me to climb tomorrow?"

"According to the plans, yes." Catra replies, "Here. Come look on the planning doc."

Adora walks over and looks at the plan on the screen and sees her name, "But… how?"

"Look at who approved it." Catra scrolls down to the signature at the bottom of the document.

"Ms Weaver approved this?" The magicat nods, "She knows I don't have the experience or the qualifications to do that job. Not by a long shot. Plus I'm just the shadow!"

“Well, up to you if you want to have a chat to her.” Catra shrugs, “Actually, yeah do that. I’d love to hear her excuses.”

The door to the site office swings open and a smirking Lonnie comes in, “We’re back.”

“Great.” Catra replies as she looks at the time, “I’ll be out there in a few minutes.”

“Take your time, boss.” Lonnie says and it sounds genuine and not a jab at the magicat, “We’ve got blondie here. I’m sure we’ll be fine to finish off the rest of the cage without you.”

“Nah, just give me a few minutes. I’ll be out there once I’m done with this email.” Catra replies without looking up, “Keep Kyle away from the welding machine.”

“Duh.” Lonnie replies with an eye roll, “Come on, Adora. Back to work. We need you to tie while we hold the side bars up. We’ll switch every couple of bars so you don’t get too bored… and my biceps stay intact.”

“Okay.” Adora replies as she grabs her water bottle, glancing back at Catra for a moment before following Lonnie back out.

An hour later…

“Drink break.” Lonnie declares after tying in the side bars, “Afterwards you and Ro bring the hurdles in and I’ll tack them in with the welder.”

“What about Catra?” Adora asks as she gulps down her water, “She said she’d be out a while ago.”

“Yeah, I wouldn’t worry about her.” Lonnie wipes her mouth after taking a drink, “She’s got bigger problems right now with sorting

out that crane."

"How do you know about the crane?" Adora asks.

"I was supposed to work that shift but then got shafted for you. Now I'm going to another job digging trenches for sewer pipes to go into." Lonnie says, "And since I know how Weaver works, she's definitely has the wrong size crane booked. So, I'm very sure right now, Catra is having a *great* time trying to book a bigger crane."

"That's…" Adora frowns as she watches Rogelio set up the welding machine.

"It's total bullshit." Lonnie finishes Adora's thought, "I think Weaver is trying to make her quit. Beats me why… but for some reason she's got a sore spot for our boss."

"Isn't that bullying?" Adora asks.

"Sure is." Lonnie laughs out, "But she needs the job. And Weaver knows it."

Rogelio grunts and waves for the rest of them to get back to work and the conversation goes back to work.

Another hour later…

Catra trudges back to the group, an apologetic look on her face as she stands on the edge, "Hey, it took a little longer than expected." The magicat looks at the progress and breathes out in relief that it's going ahead of schedule, "It's looking really good."

"Sure is, boss." Kyle calls out as he marks up the drawings, "We should be done in the next hours or so."

“Great.” Catra nods with a satisfied smile on her face, “Really good work guys. What do you want me to do?”

“We need our drink bottles refilled, boss!” Lonnie shouts out and Catra laughs as she throws her empty bottle at her, “Cold water if you’ve got it.”

“Yeah, that’s something that’s actually in this site office.” Catra grins, “I made sure of it.”

Adora sheepishly hands over her empty bottle as well, “I can go fill it up if…”

“Nope! We still need you here, Adora.” Lonnie cuts her off and Adora looks at her in question.

“I got this, Adora.” Catra replies with an air of amusement in her voice as she carries the bottles in her arms, “I’ll be back.”

One more hour passes…

“Great work guys.” Catra opens the door to the site office and pulls out the computer chair, “Sign off for ten guys.”

“But we only worked eight.” Adora points out and is elbowed in the ribs by Lonnie, “Ow!”

Catra laughs, “Sign off for ten.”

“You got it, boss!” Kyle happily pushes himself in and signs off first.

“Yeah, thanks Cat.” Lonnie agrees as Rogelio grunts out in a happier tone, “Good luck tomorrow. Did you manage to get a bigger crane?”

“Eventually yeah.” Catra nods, “I had to pull in a few favours but I got it done.”

“What kind of favours?” Adora asks.

“Using my free time to help someone pack and move, being the designated driver for a party on the weekend and being the doubles partner for said party beer pong tournament.” Catra lists off, “I think that’s it… Good thing Mermista could help me out...”

“That’s crazy!” Adora says in almost a shout.

“It is and it isn’t.” Kyle says as he puts his hand up to talk.

“The crane company probably had to pull a lot of strings to make this happen last minute.” Lonnie adds, “And most companies won’t do it for the same price as the smaller crane.”

“That’s seems like an upper management problem though.” Adora suggests.

“It sure is.” Lonnie agrees, “But they’ll find a way to still make it Cat’s fault.”

“Surely the email trail…” Adora starts and Lonnie shakes her head, “Oh… I’m assuming you’ve tried before?”

“Yep. And they cut our shifts almost immediately. If it wasn’t for Catra, we wouldn’t have jobs right now.” Kyle explains, “So, yeah, going up against management is bad for everyone.”

Rogelio grunts and the pair and Catra both nod back at him.

“Alright, get out of here guys.” Catra orders, “I’ll see you on Thursday to do formwork.”

“See you, Catra!” Kyle beams as Lonnie and Rogelio wave to her.

“Are you coming, Adora?” Lonnie asks as she’s about to exit.

“Catra’s my ride.” Adora replies sheepishly.

Lonnie just smirks at her, “Okay, we’re out! See ya!”

“Bye.” Catra says as the door shuts.

“You’re not planning to do another late one again, are you?” Adora asks as she watches Catra tap a few more times on the keyboard, “You’re going to burn out.”

“Probably.” Catra replies flatly, “But not tonight.”

“Oh yeah?” Adora brightens up, “Why’s that?”

“Because as far as I’m concerned, tomorrow is all sorted and I’m good to go.” Catra replies with a grin, “I mean, unless you want to hang out in the site office longer?”

“Nope! Let’s go!” Adora declares with a huge smile as she grabs her backpack with her extra clothes in it and heads out the door waiting for the magicat to join her.

“Okay, this is your stop, Adora.” Catra pulls up to Adora’s apartment building once again, “I’ll pick you up at the same time tomorrow morning.”

“Are you sure?” Adora asks as she unbuckles her seatbelt but stays in the car, “If it’s out of the way, I’m sure I can make my own way there.”

“It’s fine, just means we don’t need to head to the workshop in the morning.” Catra brushes off Adora’s concerns, “I’m not too far from you anyways.”

“Oh, is that right?” The blonde asks, “Can I ask where?”

“I’m about five minutes up the road.” Catra points ahead, “So, like I said, it’s fine. You’re not out of the way at all.”

“So… in that case…” Adora bites her bottom lip as she turns to look at Catra, “Come inside. I can make us dinner.”

Catra just stares back at her, unable to form words for the outward generosity from the blonde in her ute, until Adora nudges her and gives her a strange look, the magicat quickly clearing her throat, “Huh? What?”

Adora shakes her head, “It’s just dinner. Not a hookup.”

“Oh, yeah, no. I get it.” Catra tries to play it cool, clearing her throat again, “Thank you for the offer, but I think I better be heading home and all…”

“Are you always this… awkward? Or is it only around me?” Adora chuckles under her breath, “I’ll make us dinner, we’ll eat, we’ll chat, you’ll wash up and then you’ll go home.”

“Uh, why?” Catra asks dumbly, her fingers tightening around the steering wheel.

“Because it sucks eating alone in an empty apartment.” Adora admits and instantly feels like a sad and lonely loser, her smile drops slightly at the rejection that just hasn’t come yet, “But, no pressure. You don’t have to if you don’t want to.”

“What are you making?” Catra asks instead and Adora tilts her head as she looks up at the magicat, “Uh, for dinner. What are you making for dinner?”

“Pasta.”

“What kind?”

“The pasta kind…?” Adora finds herself giggling, “What kind of question is that?”

“Okay.”

“Okay?”

Catra shrugs, “Can I park here? Or is there like a visitors car park somewhere?”

“Here is fine, this is my spot anyways if I had a car.” Adora explains, “So… yes, to dinner?”

“Yeah.” Catra parks her ute up properly and then turns off the engine. The pair sitting quietly in their seats until the magicat eventually takes off the seatbelt and turns to Adora, “Okay. Uh... I get the whole eating alone in an empty apartment thing, that’s what I was planning to do tonight.”

Adora smiles, “Well, then join me tonight for dinner.”

“Okay.” Catra repeats as she watches Adora get out of ute and she takes a steady and calming breath before doing the same.

After dinner…

Adora leans against her door as Catra walks out the door, the magicat turning around to look at the blonde, her cheeks still red from laughing so much at dinner and then the resulting wash up that ended up being a slight… water fight.

“Thanks for dinner, Adora.” Catra says as she wipes her hands on her pants, “It was really good.”

“Thank you.” Adora replies, “And thank you for your company today and tonight.”

“It was my pleasure, princess.” Catra replies with a grin.

They smile at one another, a weighted silence between them as they look at each other waiting for the other to speak.

Eventually Catra rubs the back of her neck and breaks the silence, “I’ll see you tomorrow morning at 6, Adora.”

Adora nods and smiles back, she’s still leaning against the doorframe and staring at magicat, “I’ll see you in the morning, Catra.”

Catra nods back, “Get some sleep, Adora.” Then the magicat turns around and heads to her vehicle.

“Text me when you get home.” Adora asks and Catra turns back to give her an amused look, the blonde sighing, “So I can sleep knowing you didn’t crash on the way home. And that you’re safe and sound.”

The magicat nods, “You don’t have to worry about me, Adora.”

“I don’t have to, but I can’t seem to help myself.” Adora admits a little shyly, “I feel like I can’t not worry about you.”

Catra looks away, the compliment making her feel hot and a little awkward feeling like she’s been caught as she simply replies, “I worry about you too.”

“I know.”

“What?” Catra looks up confused.

“I know you worry about me.” Adora elaborates, “You waited until I was inside before you rode off yesterday.”

“Lots of people do that, don’t they?” Catra replies.

“No, Catra. Lots of people don’t do that.” Adora sighs, “But I’m glad that you did.”

The magicat shrugs, “Seems pretty standard to me.”

Adora smiles, “Goodnight Catra, text me when you get home, please.”

“Of course, Adora.” Catra replies as she heads to her ute and gets in, she starts up the engine and looks to Adora’s door to find the blonde still in her doorway, watching her. The magicat waves with a small smile as Adora waves back before she finally pulls out of the parking space and onto the road. In her rearview mirror she sees Adora go back inside and shut her door.

Wednesday 6am

“Hey Adora.” Catra greets as Adora gets into the passenger seat of her ute, “Your coffee is the one closest to you, milk and one sugar.”

“Awe, you remembered!” Adora coos as she buckles up and picks up her coffee for a sip, “Mmm… so good.”

“Glad you like it.” Catra chuckles, “Okay, let’s get going.”

630am on site

“Catra!” A moustached man comes barrelling towards the magicat, wrapping her up in a bear hug, “I was so happy you called me yesterday to once again work with you!”

“Yeah, yeah, yeah.” Catra pushes herself out of the man’s arms, “Thanks for coming in today, Seahawk.”

“And thank you for helping me with moving on the weekend!” He beams and then stage whispers to Adora, “She’s the only with a vehicle with a big enough load capacity for what I need.”

“And from what she said, she’s also your designated driver and a beer pong partner.” Adora adds flatly, Seahawk just grins back as Adora sarcastically says, “What are friends for, right?”

“He’s not getting paid for today which is why I’m doing all of that.” Catra explains, “Weaver’s only budgeted 2 people for today, not 3.”

“What about Octavia?” Adora asks.

“You’re technically not getting paid this week.” Catra replies, “Were you aware of that?”

Adora shakes her head, “No, I thought I was still getting a wage.”

“If you are, it’s essentially work experience wages.” Catra replies, “Which is less than junior rates.”

“Oh.” Adora frowns out.

“But you’re not supposed to know that until you receive your pay packet once a month.” Catra adds matter of factly, “Though you said you don’t know what you’ll be up to next week…”

“Because I don’t.” Adora continues to frown as she pulls out her phone, “I think I need to check that email that was sent from her…”

“Do it later, princess. The crane is here.” Catra says as they see the crane pulling in, the magicat heading over to talk to the operator/driver about where to set up and then waving Adora over, “Hey, can you give Kym a hand with setting this up?”

“I-I don’t know how to set up a crane.” Adora says looking at the magicat confused at even asking her to do it.

“It’s easy.” Catra grins, “All you need to do is pull out the planks and put them under the legs. Kym will tell you how she wants to stack it. I’m going to talk to Seahawk about how we’re going to get this job done and what tools we’ll need to bring up with us.”

“Uh… okay.” Adora agrees nervously as Kym comes over, “Hi.”

“Hey, I’m Kym.” A large muscular woman with a mohawk comes around the crane and gives the blonde a quick fist pump, “Since the ground here’s not too bad, we’ll just do one row on both sides.”

“Uh, sure.” Adora nods, “I’m Adora. It’s nice to meet you.”

Kym smiles back and then opens a door on the back of crane to reveal where the planks are kept, “Four under each foot please. And I’m Kym.”

The blonde nods again and pulls on her gloves and starts grabbing the planks out and setting them up under the feet of the crane.

Catra waves everyone in to do the toolbox for the job and then they all break off to their tasks. The magicat grasping Adora by the wrist and giving it a quick squeeze, “Okay, Kym’s been kind enough to help out with the rigging, but it should be pretty straightforward as all you need to do is put the hooks on the designated lifting points.” Adora nods nervously, “You’ll be fine, princess. Kym will help you if you need it and I’ll be on the radio as well.”

Adora takes in a calming breath, “Okay. But it really feels like you should have someone here that actually knows what they’re doing…”

“Kym’s a rigger, Adora.” Catra points out, “She’s got like every ticket under the sun. You’re in good hands. Trust me.”

That information makes the blonde feel a lot more at ease, nodding back to Catra and then looks up to where the magicat and Seahawk will be working, “Okay. Be safe up there.”

“Always am.” Catra grins, “Oh, I forgot, follow.”

“Huh?” Adora follows Catra to a pile of boxes on a pallet.

“When you send up the steel, I need you to send up a bag of bolts as well.” Catra explains, “We’re going to be carrying a lot of stuff up there as it already is, so just chuck a bucket full into one of those big lifting bags and hook it to the third chain. I’ll send it back down once we need a refill. Cool?”

“Which bolts do I put in the bag?” Adora crouches down to read the labels on the boxes.

“All the boxes here have the same size bolts in them.” Catra replies, “I checked it over last week when I was here to receive all the materials. And from the looks of it, it should be all here since the plastic wrap is still around it. Do you have a knife?”

“No. Am I supposed to have one?” The blonde asks as Catra hands her a flip knife, “Oh… what’s this for?”

“Cutting the plastic and opening the boxes.” Catra replies and then looks around thinking to herself to make sure she’s gone through everything and then nods, “Okay, got your radio?”

Adora pulls the radio from the back of her belt and pushes the button, “Come in, Catra.”

“Copy.” The magicat returns, “Great, they work.” Catra looks up and takes a few breaths, “Okay, if everything goes to plan, we should be done by the time lunch rolls by. And when I radio down to you to pack up, help Kym pack up the crane so we can get her out of her and get her on her way. Seahawk and I will finish off while you do that and then that should hopefully be it.”

“Sounds like a plan.” Adora nods and Catra grins.

2pm in the afternoon…

Adora waves Kym and her crane off once it's all packed up and the paperwork signed off, the blonde shuts the gate back up again so public don't accidentally wander in. She holds onto her hard hat as she looks up to where Catra and Seahawk are still working above and pulls her radio out, "Catra, have you got a copy?"

"Copy." Catra returns.

"The crane is gone. What do you want me to do with the paperwork?" Adora informs the magicat while looking up and holding her hard hat.

Catra doesn't reply straight away as she hears the sound of drills and hammers ringing out above her. After a few minutes, a breathless sounding Catra finally replies back on the radio, "Hold on to it for me, please. I'll come and grab it off you when I'm back on the ground."

"Copy that." Adora replies, "What do you want me to now? How can I help?"

"Can you do a clean up down there?" Catra asks as she grunts out a little, "There's a skip bin down there, you can chuck all the empty boxes and whatever rubbish is down there."

"On it." Adora nods and then asks one more question, "How much longer do you think you'll be?"

"We're just having a problem with this one bolt. Once we get her in there, we're pretty much done." Catra replies, "Hopefully in the next half hour or so."

Adora nods, "Okay. Take your time and stay safe up there."

"Copy that, princess." Catra replies and Adora can hear the smile in her voice.

35 minutes later…

“Good work, Seahawk.” Catra pats the moustached man on the back and then makes a face, “Gross. You’re gross and sweaty and gross.”

Seahawk mirrors the magicat and pats her on the back as well, though he just laughs, “It just means we’ve worked hard, my dear friend.”

“You’re a fucking lifesaver.” Catra says gratefully, “Fucking Weaver is really fucking with me.”

“You shouldn’t let her get to you.” Seahawk replies with a sigh, “I know things look bad now, but things will look up in time.”

“Hopefully.” Catra nods and sighs too.

“It will.” He doubles down, “You’ve always got a place on my crew if you ever want it, you know?”

“I know.” Catra grins, “But you know I don’t like water. And spending more than a few hours on the water is worse than working for Weaver.”

They share a laugh before Seahawk pats Catra on the shoulder, “Well, like I said, you are always welcome to join my crew.”

“Thanks, dude.” Catra says, “You better get going. Your Mermista is going to kill me if you don’t get home soon.”

“My dear Mermista loves you.” Seahawk says sincerely, “Hence why you are our designated driver this weekend!” He leans in and stage whispers to the magicat, “She only trusts you to keep sober.”

Catra rolls her eyes, “Sure. That’s why. Not because she knows that I’m the best at beer pong since I’ll be sober.”

Seahawk laughs, nodding in agreement, “Okay, well, I best be off.” He shakes Catra’s hand, “Have a good rest of the day, Catra.”

“You too.” Catra replies, “And thanks for coming out today.”

“Always.” He winks at her with a wide grin and sees Adora coming over, “Ah, Adora! It was very nice to meet and work with you. I hope to see you again soon! Oh! There’s a party this weekend that Catra’s going to be designated driver for me and my dear Mermista, you should come!”

“Oh, uh…” Adora looks to Catra and then back to Seahawk, “I, uh, I don’t know. I mean, I don’t really even know you and…”

“After today, I think of you as a friend!” Seahawk declares, “So, come to the party with us, friend Adora!”

The blonde can’t help but laugh at the moustached man’s antics, “Okay. I’ll go.”

“Fantastic!” Seahawk pumps his fist in the air, “Catra will let you know all the details! But for now, I have to go. See you at the party, Adora!”

“Take care, Seahawk.” Adora waves to him as he heads out of the site, closing the gates behind him. The blonde takes the radio off her belt and turns it off, “So, home time?”

“Definitely.” Catra replies zipping up her kit bag and then hauling it over her shoulder, “I just need to pack up the rest of my tools and then we can go.”

“Let me help.” Adora offers and Catra nods, handing over her kit bag, “Oof. What do you have in this thing? It’s so heavy!”

The magicat just looks at the blonde with a perplexed look on her face, “Uh, you know what’s in my kit bag princess.”

“Do I?” Adora readjusts the bag and then, “Ow! Something’s poking me!”

Catra grabs the kit bag off the blonde and shakes her head incredulously, “It’s not even that heavy, Adora. What’s the point of all those muscles if you can’t even carry my bag for me?”

“Your bag has pointy, pokey stuff in it.” Adora points out with a pout, “It hurt my back.”

“Oh shit, are you okay?” Catra asks looking at Adora’s back and trying to assess it through her shirt.

“Yeah, it just surprised me is all.” Adora replies rubbing the sore spot, “I don’t think it’s too bad.”

“Sorry about that.” The magicat drops her bag to the ground with the realisation that she might have left something in it that should be in her tool bag and not her kit bag, unzipping it and then pulling at a drift (aka. a metal spike), “Well, that shouldn’t be in there…”

“See, I told you!” Adora says, “What is that even doing in there and why did you need it up there?”

“My drift?” Catra closes her kit bag once more and holds the item up to Adora.

“Yes, the metal spike.” Adora confirms.

“It’s a drift.” The magicat repeats as she hauls her bag over her shoulder and starts to walk towards her ute.

“Whatever. Why do you even have this?” Adora waves the item around in her hand at Catra, “You know, if you get caught with this in public, they might think it’s a weapon.”

Catra dumps her kit bag into the toolbox of her ute and then takes the drift back from Adora, “Which is why it stays in my toolbox when I’m not using it.”

“What is it for?” Adora asks again.

“Landing the steel beams.” Catra replies as opens her toolbox and drops the drift into it with a thump, “Also means I’m not bashing the crap out of my podgers. And trust me, they aren’t cheap or easy to get. Not the good ones anyways.”

“I have no idea what you’re talking about.” Adora replies with a frown.

“I’ll show you one day.” Catra says as she starts to head back to collect the rest of her tools, “Can you grab all my power tools and put them in the blue toolbox?”

“Sure.” Adora says and they both make good time getting the rest of tools packed away and the site tidied the blonde finally takes off her gloves and puts them in her back pocket and then removes her helmet, realising something, “Hey, why weren’t you wearing a helmet?”

“Because there’s nothing and no one above us.” Catra replies, “I thought you just liked wearing the hat…”

“No. It’s itchy!” The blonde whines as she scratches her head, holding the helmet out to Catra, “Here. You can have it back.”

“Yeah, no thanks.” Catra pushes it back to the blonde, “You can keep that. It’s got your sweaty forehead all over it.”

The blonde rolls her eyes and sighs, “Can we go now?”

“Yes.” Catra replies, “Do me favour and drive my ute out so I can lock up?”

“You’re letting me drive your car?” Adora asks with a slight smile on her face, “You trust me that much with your baby?”

“Okay, one, my ute is not my baby. And two, refer to point one, it’s not a car, it’s a ute.” Catra says, “And yes, I do trust you to just take my ute out the gates so I can lock up.”

Catra pulls the keys out from her pocket and hands them over to Adora, “Thank you.” The blonde says and jumps into the driver’s seat, “Ow!”

“What? What happened?” Catra rushes over to where Adora is rubbing her knee and then chuckles, “Oh, yeah, you might want to move the seat back.”

“Yeah.” Adora reaches under and pulls the lever and pushes the seat back, she looks over with her face still scrunched up in the aftermath or the bump, “You’re so short.”

Catra doesn’t even respond to that, instead walking over to the gate and opening, stepping out to check no one’s coming their way before waving he blonde over, “You’re all clear to exit, Adora.”

She starts the engine and then puts the ute in gear and lurches forward, “Oof…” before accidentally stalling, “Fuck… um…”

Catra watches on a little amused, “Do you want to swap?”

“No! I got it!” Adora shouts back, starting the engine up again and then lurching forward again and stalling, “Come on!”

Shaking her head, Catra pulls the gate shut behind her once more and walks towards her ute that Adora is absolutely killing her gearbox, she taps on window and the blonde glares at her, “Out. You do the gate.”

“Ugh! Fine.” Adora concedes and gets out of the ute, Catra readjusts her seat and waits for Adora to open up the gate for her. The magicat driving out and pulling off and parking up just outside before getting out and heads back to gate, “Key?”

“Here.” Catra hands over the site keys, “It’s the green one.”

Adora nods and locks up, giving it a little shake to make sure it’s secured and then hands the key back to the magicat, “I’m starving.”

“Me too.” Catra agrees, “Why didn’t you get something to eat while me and Seahawk were finishing up before?”

“Didn’t seem right.” Adora shrugs.

“You’re such an idiot.” Catra says fondly, “Do you want to grab something or did you want me to drop you back home?”

“Food first.” Adora declares, Then you can drop me off after.”

“I knew it.” Catra grins.

“Knew what?” Adora asks as they get back into the ute.

“Knew you were boss material.” Catra replies as she turns the engine back on.

“Boss material? How?” Adora quirks an eyebrow up as she does up her seatbelt.

Catra pulls out of the parking space and onto the road before answering with a mischievous grin, “You’re bossy.”

“Oh, you totally did that on purpose!” Adora pouts at the fact she can’t do anything to Catra while the vehicle is moving.

“What? It’s true. I’m practically at your beck and call, princess.” Catra says with a smirk, “Not that I’m complaining.”

“That’s because you like me.” Adora blurts out and then panics, “Oh shit, I didn’t mean to say that. It’s totally inappropriate because we’re coworkers and you know the whole dating a colleague thing is wrong.”

“Woah… breathe Adora.” Catra grabs the blonde’s hand with her free one, “We can like each other and still be professional.”

“Can we?” Adora asks looking away.

“Yeah, why not?” Catra replies a little too easily and it makes Adora’s heart sink a little, but she knows they really can’t be more

than what they are right now. Then Catra says, "You're not going to be shadowing me forever, Adora. And when we aren't working together, well, we won't need to be… professional anymore."

"Oh." Adora mouth moves, a smile coming back onto her lips, "Yeah. 2 more days and then who knows where I'll be, right?"

"I definitely won't know." Catra replies, "Unless you tell me, I guess."

"Hm." Adora replies instead of responding to that, swiftly changing the subject, "Where are we getting food?"

Thursday 630am

"Hey Adora, coffee?" Catra pulls up once again in her ute.

"Thank you." The blonde smiles and takes a sip from the cup closest to her, "You have to let me know how much I owe you for all these coffees so I can pay you back."

"Nah, don't worry about it, Adora." Catra replies as she gets back onto the road and heads toward the workshop, "Besides having a shadow means I get an extra pair of hands for the week. Which in my books is generally pretty bad, because some of the *shadows* I've had in the past have been worse than awful."

"I'm going to take that as a compliment." Adora says as she sips her coffee, "But no, really. How much for the coffee?"

"Don't worry about it." Catra repeats as she drums her fingers on the steering wheel trying to get to the end of this conversation, "Thursday is usually workshop day."

"I'm treating you to lunch and dinner." Adora says catching Catra off guard.

“It’s really not necessary, Adora. Really.” Catra tries brush off the blonde’s offers, “If anything, a few coffees for a good pair of extra hands is worth more than your lunches and dinners.”

“That’s… actually really sad, Catra.” Adora sighs, “H.E is taking advantage of you.”

“I know.” Catra replies, “But you know I need this job. Got bills to pay and my stomach to fill.”

Adora shakes her head sadly, “You’re more than this job, Catra. If you were anywhere else… you’d be a supervisor or manager by now. And not… living paycheck to paycheck…”

Catra hums back, tightening her grip on the steering wheel before relaxing slightly, “So, we’re at the workshop today…”

“Right.” Adora replies sadly.

Lunch time…

“Hey Catra!” Scorpia comes over, a beaming smile on her face when she sees the magicat and it’s not long before she’s swept Catra up into a big hug and then releasing her apologetically, “Sorry. But you know I’m a hugger.”

“Hey Scorp.” Catra shakes herself off, “And yes, I know. Did you get your place sorted?”

“Oh, yes! Thank you so much for letting me take a few days off last week.” The large scoripini says, “It took forever to finally talk to someone over the phone to get the power to my place turned back on all because they got the billing account numbers wrong.”

“It’s fine, Scorp.” Catra replies, “It was a pretty slow week last week if I remember right. Mostly spent waiting for deliveries to

turn up."

"Well, if you need anything, let me know." Scorpia offers sincerely, "I mean it, Wildcat."

"I know. But I'm fine, big gal." Catra chuckles trying not to let her friend's very kind offer make her feel mushy and then realises she can change the focus of this conversation, "Hey, have you met Adora?"

"Adora… no, I don't think so." Scorpia replies, Catra pulls the blonde forward by the arm and Scorpia can't help but grin and then looks at Adora, "Hi Adora. I'm Scorpia, gosh, it's so nice to meet you. I'm a bit of the all rounder around here."

"Hi Scorpia. It's nice to meet you too." Adora reaches out and shakes Scorpia claw, "I'm shadowing Catra for the week. It's been… eye opening."

"Oh, Wildcat here is the best." Scorpia gushes about the magicat, "If there's someone that can get the job done, it's Catra. Quick on her feet physically and metaphorically."

Adora turns to Catra with a *I told you so* look and then says to Scorpia, "I'm surprised that they haven't promoted her to a supervisor or something by now. It's absolutely criminal."

"Oh, I know, right?" Scorpia frowns before her phone pings and she pulls it out, nearly dropping it in the process, "That's me. I've got to go. Truck's good to go. So, I got to go too."

Catra chuckles as she waves her friend off, "See ya, Scorp."

Her scorpini friend rushes off, nearly barrelling into a few other workers to get back to where she's supposed to be.

"Come on, we're nearly done." Catra says as they go back to work.

“How many left?” Adora looks around to see if they’ve missed anything.

“Okay, I think that should be the last one.” Catra says going through the last box and checking the contents before putting it on the pallet, “Now we just need to label it and then wrap it up.”

Adora nods and they start getting the pallet wrapped up while Catra prints out a label for the contents, once the blonde is done and the label added, Adora turns to the magicat and grins, “Lunch! My treat!”

As Catra is about to reply, Shadow Weaver’s voice jolts them out of their little bubble, “Adora. There you are. I’ve been looking all over for you.”

“Oh! Ms Weaver. Hi.” Adora says trying to sound casual, “I'm still shadowing Catra like the schedule says to. What are you doing here?”

“You are in the Horde Enterprise’s workshop after all.” Shadow Weaver replies towering over the pair, “Come. Join me for lunch and then we discuss your activities for next week.”

Adora looks between Shadow Weaver and Catra feeling torn, “That’s… uh, that’s very nice of you…”

“Great. I’ll give you a lift.” Shadow Weaver says as she turns around to walk away.

Catra slinks back slightly, “I’ll see you later, Adora. Enjoy lunch.” She looks at Shadow Weaver’s back, “It was such a pleasure seeing you again, Ms… Weaver.”

The reaction is sudden, the tall, dark and scary woman spins around so quickly that’s she’s in front of Catra, looming and towering over the magicat with a glare in her eyes, “Do not test me, Catra. You are already on thin ice. Don’t think I don’t know you let Scorpia take a few days off last week without consulting your supervisor.”

"How's that? My *supervisor* is never on site!" The magicat doesn't back down, "I had Scorpia's shifts covered as she needed time off and as far as I'm concerned, I've done everything you've asked of me even, with you sabotaging me on every, single job."

"Well in that case…" Shadow Weaver drops her voice, there's definitely what looks like a smile or a smirk on her face despite it being covered by her mask, "You're fired. Now, get out before I call security."

"Wait, no." Adora protests loudly, "You can't just fire her!"

Shadow Weaver ignores Adora's protests, looking down at Catra in satisfaction, "Get out. Now."

Catra shrugs, "Fine. But I better get all the hours and leave I'm owed." The magicat shakes her head at Adora to just let it go, much to the blonde's chagrin. Catra pulls out her keys and takes off 3 keys off the large set of keys and holds them out to Shadow Weaver, "Here. These are your problem now."

Shadow Weaver takes the big stack of keys as Catra walks towards the exit, the TDSW sneers at her and then threatens, "If I find that you've taken any Horde property with you in any shape or form, I will make sure you have less than nothing and begging for prison time."

Catra's ears twitch with that threat but she doesn't turn around, instead stopping next to Adora, "I'll pick you up when your shift finishes so you can get home."

Adora doesn't reply, still shocked by what she'd just witnessed as Catra walks out of the workshop. The blonde turns back to Shadow Weaver who looks very pleased with herself, "Come Adora, I'm taking you out for lunch."

3pm. Outside of Horde Enterprises property…

“Need a ride?” Catra pulls up on her motorcycle, the spare jacket and helmet waiting for Adora on back of her bike.

Adora smiles at the magicat, putting the items on before taking her place behind Catra, “Yes please!”

Chuckling, Catra turns her head slightly to talk to Adora, “Where to? Home?”

“No.” Adora replies, “Actually yes.”

The blonde’s indecisiveness has Catra laughing out, “Which is it? Home or no?”

“I need to change first before we go anywhere.” Adora replies.

“What’s wrong with what you’ve got on now? You look nice.” Catra says, the compliment accidentally coming out but then decides to go with it, “I mean, yeah, you do.”

Adora is glad her helmet covers her blush, but a smile appears on her face, “I feel… dirty.”

Catra nods knowingly, “Yeah alright. Hang on then, princess.”

The blonde wraps her arms tightly around Catra’s waist, leaning her front tight against the magicat’s back as Catra get going towards Adora’s place one last time.

At the diner later…

“Do you want me to drive you to work tomorrow?” Catra asks as they wait for their empty plates to be cleared.

“You’re going to drive me to work even though you don’t work there anymore?” Adora repeats slowly looking at Catra incredulously, “Why? Why would you do that?”

“Well, I’ve got nothing else to do. And I can’t sleep past 5am.” The magicat shrugs, “Might as well be productive.”

Adora sighs, shaking her head, “I can’t believe she just fired you.”

“I’m surprised she waited a whole 2 years to do it.” Catra replies leaning back so the server can clear the table and then says, “They better pay me everything I’m owed.”

“What are you going to do now?” The blonde asks as she asks for the bill from the server before they take off.

“Take up Seahawk’s offer to work on his boat.” The magicat says tapping her claws on the table before groaning out and resting her head on her arms, “I’m hate the water…”

Adora pats Catra on the back, “I’m sure you’ll find something else…”

Catra just groans again in response before lifting her head up, “I needed that job.”

“You deserve better than that job.” Adora says and Catra drops her head back down onto her arms again, “What can I do to make you feel better?”

One of Catra’s ears perk up before the second one does the same, the magicat pats them back down on her head as she shakes her head of thoughts of Adora making her feel… *better.*

Adora just looks at the magicat amused, “I have an idea.”

“Mm.”

The server put the bill on the table between the pair and Adora pulls out enough cash to cover their meals, “Come on, I’ve got an

idea that'll make you feel better."

"Doesitincludegettingnakedwtihme…" Catra mutters out into her arms."

"Huh?" Adora tilts her head as she doesn't understand a single word the magicat had just uttered, "What did you say?"

"Nothing." Catra sits back up straight and then sighs, "So, what's this idea of yours that's going to make me happy?"

"You'll see." Adora smiles as she gets up and holds her hand out to Catra, "Come on. You're driving."

"Of course, I am." Catra rolls her eyes but there's a hint of a smile on her lips, "Unless you're secretly a biker chick or something."

"No. Definitely not." Adora laughs, "Come on, it's getting late."

"So?" Catra grumbles as she takes Adora's hand and gets up, "It's not like I have to be anywhere tomorrow."

"Yes, you do." Adora replies, "You're picking me up to drive me to work."

"Sounds like you want a boyfriend." Catra grumbles out as she shrugs her jacket on and then realises that Adora's not following, "Are you coming?"

"Boyfriend?" Adora repeats a little amused, "What makes you think I want a boyfriend?"

"Uh… I don't know." Catra replies narrowing her eyes at the blonde to see if she's playing or not, "You… you don't want a boyfriend?"

"Stars no." Adora shakes her head.

"Okay… so, no boyfriend." Catra tilts her head, "I don't want to assume…"

“Assume what?” Adora knows she’s teasing, but if it takes Catra’s mind off the day’s nastiness then she’ll go with it just to see the magicat smile again, “What don’t you want to assume?”

Catra looks at Adora and then thinks to herself that they’re no longer coworkers, shrugs to herself and then says without a second thought, “Well, if I’m being honest, I really want to assume that you’re into me. Because, fuck, I’m really into you and I really want to be in to you.”

Adora’s face turns bright red, her eyes widen in realisation her tease had completely backfired, “I don’t think that’s a good idea…”

“Yeah, me neither.” Catra admits with a sigh, “Come on, I’ll take you home.”

Adora nods and then remembers, “Wait, hold on, I still have an idea.”

Catra nods to her and starts to walk out of the diner and to her bike, swinging her leg over and taking a seat on it, “Well, tell me this idea of yours.”

10 minutes later…

“Where are we going, Adora?” Catra laughs as she pulls up to a traffic light, Adora’s arms wrapped around her middle and her front against her back making her feel warm and safe, “Do you actually have a destination in mind.”

“Nope.” Adora replies with a grin in her voice, “I know how much you like riding and I thought you’d like some company while you did it.”

The traffic light turns green and Catra takes off again down the road, the sound of her engine too loud to have a proper

conversation as she decides to take Adora home.

Adora doesn't realise it until Catra parks up her bike in front of her apartment, "You took me home?"

"Yeah." Catra replies as she waits for Adora to dismount her bike, "It's getting late, princess."

"I'm not tired yet." Adora pouts as she pulls the magicat in tighter, "And it's going to be a crappy day tomorrow because my favourite coworker isn't going to be there tomorrow."

Catra sighs, "Sorry."

"It's not your fault." Adora says, "Ms Weaver fired you. For no reason other than that you stood up for yourself and your coworker."

"What has she got you doing tomorrow?" Catra asks through curiosity, "Friday is usually a shit show of a day. Weaver loves to schedule all the big jobs on Friday because she loves watching everyone, sorry, let me correct that, me, she loves watching me scramble and panic and fuck things up."

"But you don't." Adora replies, "You don't scramble, panic or fuck things up."

"Don't I?" The words come out snappy but Adora lets it slide, it's been a long and tough day after all.

"No. You really don't." the blonde replies softly.

"You've never seen me work on a Friday." Catra makes an unconvinced sound and then asks, "What are you doing tomorrow?"

"Shadowing Octavia." Adora answers with a grimace, "Ms Weaver kept going on and on about how much better she is compared to you. It's quite annoying how much energy she puts into actively talking bad things about you."

“Reckon she’s got a crush on me or something?” Catra jests before a cold shiver goes down her spine at the thought, “Gross. Now, I’m going to need to take shower to clean myself off from all those gross thoughts…”

Adora laughs, “Yeah, I don’t want to think about that.”

“I think she secretly has a crush on you.” Catra chuckles, “She’s always so nice to you. Even treated you to lunch and offered you a lift on more than one occasion. Totally buttering you up.”

The blonde shudders, “Gross… now I’m going to need a shower too.”

They both burst out laughing as Adora finally lets up and gets off the motorbike, Catra following suit, she takes her helmet and smooths down her fur, letting her ears free to twitch around, “What time do you want me to pick you up tomorrow, Adora?”

“Um…” Adora takes off her helmet and then furrows her brow and pulls her phone out, “Hang on, let me just check.”

“Sure.” Catra says leaning back against her bike as she takes the helmet out of Adora’s hand.

“I’m supposed to be at the workshop for a 7am start.” Adora reads her updated schedule and then makes a face, “It doesn’t say anything else. Just 7am, workshop.”

“With Octavia?”

“Yes.” Adora nods, “Wait, are you picking me up on this or the ute?”

“Haven’t decided yet.” Catra shrugs and then hands the helmet back to Adora who takes it gingerly, “Hold on to the jacket and the helmet, just in case.”

“Um, okay.” Adora replies.

"I'll text you in the morning if I'm going to take my bike in the morning." The magicat says seeing the apprehension on Adora's face about her mode of transportation, "Also, Octavia's not going to be at the workshop in the morning. Lazy piece of shit is always late, and she'll go probably straight to site and then blame you for being late and at the wrong location."

Adora quirks an eyebrow up at the magicat in intrigue.

Catra closes her eyes to gather her thoughts, "Octavia should be working on the Bornholm site tomorrow, from memory… she always gets the easy ones on Friday so my guess… there'll be a crew of probably 5 or 6 with you to do the actual work. She's not even going to look over the plans because I've already staffed that crew with people that know what to do…"

"You did?" the surprise on Adora's face makes the magicat chuckle, "But… why?"

"I'm not about to screw over good crew because the supervisor is a jackass." Catra replies, "And you know what they say. Good crew is happy crew. And the happier the crew the get, the quicker and more efficient shit gets done. As much as I hate to admit it, my crew always have my back, so I've tried to have theirs."

"It's too bad that you won't be there to look after them like that anymore." Adora sighs, "I've got a feeling things at H.E aren't going to go well for a while. A long while. Not until something changes."

Catra nods and then clears her throat, "Well, it's getting late. You've got one more day to go, so you better rest up because it's going to be a shit day if you've got Octavia as your supervisor."

"I'm shadowing her though." Adora corrects.

The magicat laughs out cynically, "She's not even going to be there to shadow. Actually, now that I think about it… dress warm in the morning, because you and the crew may be standing

around outside the site until someone comes along with a set of keys to access it."

"Seriously?!" Adora grumbles, "Might have to shout you breakfast too then."

"We'll see." Catra grins and then puts her helmet back on, "Goodnight Adora. I'll see you in the morning."

"Okay. Text me when you get home?" Adora asks as she heads to her door, keys in hand.

Rolling her eyes but smiling, "Of course. I wouldn't want you to be restless because you can't sleep due to worrying about me. Can I?"

"No, I really can't." Adora smiles and then unlocks her door, "I'll see you in the morning, Catra."

"You sure will." Catra replies as she watches Adora open and then go inside, glancing one last time over at the magicat with a short wave before shutting and locking the door. Catra gets back on her bike and turns it over before heading on home.

Friday 6am

"You have no idea how happy I was when you texted me to say you're driving in today in this and not on your bike." Adora says with relief in her voice, picking up her coffee and sipping it, "I thought I was treating you for breakfast this morning…"

"You still can." Catra replies with a grin, "There's a café on the way that do really good breakfast wraps. Treat me to one of them and we'll call it even."

“Deal!” Adora jumps on that quickly, “Does it have lunch stuff too?”

“Yeah. Though there’s a few places you can get lunch around Bornholm.” Catra says.

“What are you planning on doing today?” Adora asks.

“Not sure.” Catra replies, “Want me to pick you up later?”

“Well, that’d actually be really good if you could.” Adora nods, “But I’ll need you to drop me off back at the workshop if that’s okay.”

“Why?”

“I have a meeting with Ms Weaver about moving forward.” Adora says as she taps her coffee cup with a finger, “Actually, it’d be really good if you came with me. Moral support or whatever.”

“Pretty sure I’d get kicked out if I set foot in there.” Catra laughs, “And what do you even need my support for? Pretty sure they’re planning to just promote you to supervisor or team leader. Heck, I wouldn’t put it past them to give you a managerial title.”

Adora rolls her eyes as she takes a sip of the coffee, “Whatever. Come with me? Please.”

Catra sighs out dramatically, “Fine. But if I get arrested, you have to bail me out.”

“You’re not going to get arrested or thrown out.” Adora says with a chuckle, “I promise.”

“Oh, because you promise.” Catra repeats sarcastically, and then sees the pout on Adora’s face and the magicat groans, “Stars… fine. I’ll be there for moral support or whatever.”

“Yay!” Adora celebrates, her goofiness bringing a smile to the magicat’s face.

7am on site…

"Are they also working on site today?" Adora asks pointing to the small group of people milling around the outside of the work site waiting to get let in.

"Yeah." Catra looks over and nods, the small group recognise her and wave, "Oh crap."

"What?" Adora asks as she see the small group coming towards them.

One of them taps on the window of Catra's ute, "Hey boss. Got keys?"

Lowering the window down, Catra shakes her head, "You're out of luck, Slick. I handed my keys back yesterday."

Slick's eyes widen for a moment before he shakes his head with a chuckle, "Come on, boss. Quit playing and open the site up for us. We want to get started already. It's Friday and I don't want to be finishing late."

"I'm not joking, Slick." Catra says seriously and he instantly stops laughing, his face dropping as the magicat adds, "Weaver fired me yesterday. So, yeah. No keys. You'll have to wait for your supervisor."

"Fuck me…" Slick groans out as he looks around at his equally stunned coworkers before digging out his phone and then groans again when he finds out who the supervisor is, "You have to be fucking kidding me, boss. Octavia. Fucking Octavia. She's not going to be here for hours!"

The magicat shrugs, "Grab some breakfast or something in the meantime."

“Nah, fuck this. I’m calling the company. This is bullshit.” He grumbles before reaching inside and patting the magicat on the shoulder, “Also, I’ll put in a good word for you when I get to my other job next week, boss.”

“Thanks, Slick. But you really don’t have to do that.” Catra tries to decline but Adora cuts in.

“That’s so nice of you.” Slick looks through the window and sees the blonde.

“Oh, Slick. This is Adora.” Catra quickly introduces, “She’s supposed to be shadowing Octavia today and help you guys out.” Adora waves to him from the passenger’s seat, “Adora, this s Slick. He’s one of the best form workers I know.”

“It’s nice to meet you, Adora.” Slick greets with a smile and then turns to Catra, “New?”

“Started this week.” Catra answers as Slick chuckles to himself, ‘What? What’s so funny about her being new?”

“You’re an idiot.” Slick nudges Catra on the shoulder, “I meant is she your new girlfriend?”

Adora looks to Catra to see what she’ll say. The magicat letting that question linger for a minute and then finally replies, “Well, not yet.”

That answer makes Adora laughs, “Not yet, huh?”

“Well, yeah.” Catra shrugs, “It’s too soon to ask you out and all.”

“Is it?”

“Isn’t it?”

“Why?” Adora asks with a smile, and she can see Slick snickering on the far side of the window, “Why not yet?”

“Doesn’t feel like the right time.” Catra says with a grin and then turns to Slick, “If I were you, I’d call your actual boss and tell them that you’re still waiting outside site. And if you have to leave late, tell them that you’ll be working double time on account of it being a Friday.”

He shoots the magicat a confirming look and then winks at her, “Good idea. Maybe they’ll kick her ass to get her here already. It was good seeing you, boss. And Adora, hopefully it won’t be too long before we can actually start working.”

Adora nods and pulls out her own phone once Slick walks back to the group of people still waiting to start work, “I think I’m going to call Ms Weaver. This is ridiculous.”

An hour later…

A car comes screeching to a stop in front of the work site as a very disgruntled Octavia practically rips the door off as she gets out and angrily opens the door for the site and then grunts out, “Sign in and get to work.”

“You better get in there, princess.” Catra says and then grins, “Looks like Weaver really likes you if she’s forced Octavia to get to site so quickly after you called her. So… I got a feeling she’ll probably suck up to you. I think you should stick the boot into her, make her *really* work. Fuck, that’d be funny. I’ve never seen her lift a finger to help… so… maybe…”

“I’ll get a video for you.” Adora laughs, “I have to get to work.”

“Have fun.” Catra nods as she watches Adora exit her ute, “I’ll pick you up around 3pm.”

“I’ll see you later, Catra.” Adora waves back to the magicat as she quickly goes into the site to start work.

3pm outside the work site.

The crew exit first, waving to Catra as they leave looking exhausted, the magicat waves back as she waits for Adora to exit.

It doesn't take long as Adora exits next, Octavia not too far behind her, they seem to be… friendly. Octavia is even smiling as she talks to Adora and the way she touches the blonde's arm makes the magicat growl out as she glares at them. She's about to storm out of her ute when she sees the way that Adora moves away uncomfortably as Octavia moves closer and then in an intimidating way, tries to box the blonde in.

"Back off!" Adora shoves Octavia back.

"Keep your mouth shut then, blondie." Octavia snarks back, "Or I will make your work life here hell."

Adora glares at her, "You're a shit supervisor."

Octavia growls at hearing that, obviously never been talked down to by someone deemed inferior, "Oh yeah?"

"Yeah." Adora stands her ground.

And that's when Octavia's raises her fist in the air threateningly and then she's abruptly shoved backwards by an angry magicat, "Piss off, asshole!" Catra warns as she stands over her old supervisor, "Don't you dare fucking touch her! Leave her alone and go back to your hole under that rock."

Octavia gets up and shoves Catra back, "At least I'm not going to get fired if I pummel you into the ground."

"Stop!" Adora shouts out as Octavia grabs Catra by the shirt and Catra does the same back, fists raised and ready for a fight, they

both pause without throwing a punch, the blonde pulls Catra back and stands between the pair and then repeats a lot more calmly, "Stop."

The fire still rages on behind the large woman's eyes as she growls out, "Whatever." And then turns around but not without a final taunt, "If you keep working here, I'm going to make your life miserable. You can count on that, blondie."

"Fuck off." Catra hisses out.

"Catra." Adora grabs the magicat's hand, ignoring Octavia, "Come on. I need to go back to the workshop to finish up with Ms Weaver still."

And once Octavia is gone and out of sight, Catra sighs, "Okay. I'll get you back to the workshop."

Back at the workshop…

Catra waits in the hallway as Adora does her exit interview and finally comes out, a bright smile on her face when she sees Catra. The magicat can't help but mirror her smile until she hears Shadow Weaver's voice.

"Are you sure, Adora?" Her tone sounds surprised, "You would be well renumerated for your time here if you stay on."

"No, thank you." Adora politely declines, "But thank you for the offer."

TDSW sees Catra and glares at her through her mask, "You are making a mistake, Adora. Such potential… wasted." Shadow Weaver takes a step forward, "It'd be shame if rumours started swirling around with your involvement with a certain *former*

employee…" she chuckles under her breath, "It wouldn't be good for your reputation is all I'm saying."

Adora takes a calming breath and then says, "Again, thank you for the opportunity to work here. It was a real… eye opener…" the blonde turns to Catra, "Have a great weekend, Ms Weaver."

Shadow Weaver doesn't bother replying, instead turning around and going back to the office and Catra swears she can hear her grumble out some explicit under her breath before she almost slams the door shut.

"Are you okay?" Catra asks as they step outside of the building and make their way to where the magicat had parked on the side of the street, "Look, you didn't have to knock it back for me. I'm okay with it. Besides, having you in there, you could have made changes for the better."

"No. I don't think so." Adora shrugs as she waits for Catra to unlock the door so she can climb into the ute, "I think if I stayed and worked for them, I'd probably turn out just as bad as them."

"I don't believe that." Catra says as she puts the key into the ignition, "So, I take it that was your last day there…"

The blonde nods, "Yeah, after working today without you there, I don't think I'd last much longer."

"That bad, huh?"

"She had no idea what she was doing. Like at all!" Adora bemoans, "How did she even get to be a supervisor?"

"Beats me." Catra shrugs, "So, where to?"

"I'm free!" Adora laughs out and grins widely, "Let's go get ice cream!"

The magicat laughs, "Whatever you want, princess."

Once Catra gets onto the road, the blonde asks, "So, what did you do today?"

"Honestly?" Adora nods as Catra sighs, "I really didn't do anything. Literally once you went into the site, I went straight home and went back to bed. Slept the entire day away until I got up to pick you up."

The blonde nods, "That sounds really relaxing." Adora smiles at the magicat, "This party that Seahawk was talking about… when is it?"

"Does this mean you're planning to come?" Catra glances over with a grin.

"Depends." Adora replies, "When is it?"

"Sunday." Catra replies, "Tomorrow, I'm helping them move out and into their new place. I'm probably going to end up crashing on their couch afterwards so if you want to just meet me there at some point, we can head to the party together after."

"And what time is 'some point?'" Adora asks as the magicat parks up by an ice cream parlour, "I don't think I can stay too late on Sunday night though."

"Why? Are you working on Monday or something?" Catra asks confused, "Already got another job lined up? Geez, that's very efficient of you."

The blonde just smiles back and unbuckles her seatbelt, "Maybe I should just meet you there?"

"I can always drop you off after." Catra offers, "Seahawk and Mermista won't stay too late."

"How do you know that?" Adora asks.

"Well, knowing them… they'll want to break in their new bed or probably break the bed." Catra laughs, "Pretty sure once Seahawk

starts singing, that's going to be the end of the night for them. 10pm is what I'm thinking. 1030pm at the latest."

Adora thinks about it, "Okay. I'll come."

"Great." Catra replies, "Come on, I'll buy you a waffle cone once you pick a flavour or two."

"No. My treat." Adora protests, "I'm not taking advantage of you. You're already driving me everywhere."

"So?"

"So, I feel bad." Adora admits.

"And you're also unemployed." Catra points out, "How is that any different?"

"Just, let me? Please?" Adora does her best puppy dog eyes at the magicat, "I'll get you a plain cone with one flavour if it makes you feel better about me paying."

The magicat rolls her eyes, "Fine. But only if I get to take you out on a date."

"Deal." Adora grins and then waits for the question, her fingers fidgeting with the hem of her shirt as she hears Catra breathing and sees the magicat's ears twitching around.

"Adora?" Catra finally breaks the silence.

"Yes?"

"I-I think I want a waffle cone instead of a plain cone." Adora furrows her brows at the request as she sees Catra smirking at her as the magicat chuckles, "Let me get another job first before I ask you out, princess."

"I'll hold you to that." Adora replies and then holds her hand out to Catra, "Shake on it."

"Seriously?" The blonde nods, "Ugh, fine."

They shake hands, "Ice cream now?"

"Sure." Catra grins back, getting out of the ute and walk into the ice cream parlour.

Sunday night…

Catra sits on the couch after winning her third round of beer pong before Mermista finally got tired of winning and goes to get herself a drink of anything other than beer. The magicat watches the rest of the party goers, some in small groups chatting away and then there are the couples slow dancing to whatever music is on, even if it's a fast beat dance track. She looks around and spots Scorpia doing that slow dance with Perfuma, completely in their own little bubble as she sighs out.

Adora had texted her telling her that she was going to be late and to pass on the address for the party and she'll try to make it if she can.

The magicat looks at the time and sighs again.

10pm.

Still no sight of Adora.

Another sigh.

"Oof!" A familiar blonde falls into Catra's lap, nearly spilling her drink in the process as Adora looks up sheepishly but giggling, trying to get herself off and out of the magicat's lap, "Shit… I'm so sorry! I didn't mean to, oof!"

Catra grins, wrapping an arm around Adora's middle to keep her in place, "No, stay."

The blonde rolls her eyes, Catra laughs as she helps her up so they're sitting next to each other, "Sorry I'm late."

"It's fine." Catra replies generally happy just to see the blonde, the one day they didn't see each her makes her feel… relieved, "Everything okay?"

"Yes." The blonde replies brushing back a few stray hairs that have come free from her ponytail, "My friends wanted to come, and they took forever to get ready."

"Your friends?" Catra asks and Adora nods, looking around for her friends.

"Yeah, best friends, really." Adora sees them and points them out, "They insisted on dropping me off."

"Are they planning to stay?" The magicat asks as she spots the pair, a dark skinned man wearing a crop top with his arm around a sparkly haired woman dressed in lavender and speaking with a few other party goers, "They seem social."

"They really are." Adora grins, "It's 10 o'clock and I've had two drinks."

"Just after 10 actually. Are you drunk?" Catra corrects tiredly as she sees Seahawk and Mermista waving to her, "And I am being summoned for my chauffeuring duties, princess."

"I'm not drunk. I'm just a lightweight…" the blonde giggles to herself a little and the watches as Catra gets up, patting the blonde's thigh as she does so, "Are you leaving already?"

"Yeah, I did agree to drive them home." Catra replies, "Feel free to stay and enjoy the party, Adora. I'll see you… uh… some other time, I guess."

Adora gets up quickly and a little shakily, grabbing the magicat's hand before she can walk away, "Catra, wait."

"Yeah?" Catra turns around and tilts her head.

"What are you doing tomorrow?" Adora asks shyly as she releases Catra's hand.

"Nothing. I've got… nothing." Catra replies looking down, "What, what about you?"

"I've got… something." Adora says, "Just something I've got to do."

Catra nods, "Well, it was good to see you, Adora. Take care, yeah?"

"Wait!" The blonde quickly reaches out again, this time wrapping her arms around the magicat's neck, Catra's eyes widen as she sees Adora's eyes flick between the magicat's eyes and mouth, she licks her lips and leans in.

"Woah…" Catra pulls back.

"What? I thought…" Adora pulls back as well, scared that she'd done something wrong as she looks at the magicat, "I'm so sorr…"

Before Adora can pull back even further, Catra's puts her hands on Adora's waist and brings her back in for a hug, the magicat whispering, "I'm going to kiss you." The blonde looks up surprised but unable to see Catra's face, but the magicat chuckles and shakes her head, turning her head slightly and rubbing her cheek against Adora's, "Just not tonight…"

"Why not tonight?" Adora pouts on Catra's shoulder, the magicat able to feel the pout against her cheek.

"Because…"

"Because?" Adora whispers back.

“Hey! Wildcat!” Mermista shouts out from the far side, “Time to go!”

Catra grins back at her, giving her a thumbs up as Seahawk and Mermista make their way drunkenly to the exit as Catra leans back enough to be eye to eye with Adora, a soft smile on her lips as she says, “I can’t kiss you tonight because… I won’t be able to stop kissing you afterwards and that would mean I can’t drive anyone home.”

It takes a moment for the words to sink in and when it does Adora smiles widely, leaning in playfully and pressing her lips against the magicat’s cheek, “Well… I can’t let you let your friends down, can I?”

Catra turns her head and grins wider, “What about you? Do you need a ride home too?”

Adora looks over at her friends who wave at her as she sighs, “No. Bow’s driving me home tonight.”

Seeing Adora’s friends easily gel with the rest of the party goers, the magicat decides to grab Adora by the hand and bring her to her friends, stopping in front of the pair, “Hey. Are you guys with Adora?”

“Hi! Yes! Adora is our best friend! I’m Bow.” Bow introduces himself, “You must be Catra. She talks about you all the time.”

“I do not!” Adora tries to protest much to her friends amusement, the blonde turning to Catra, completely red in the face, redder than just from the alcohol as she tries to play it cool, “I don’t talk about you *all the time.”*

“I’m Glimmer, and she definitely does.” Glimmer snickers at Adora’s blush after introducing herself, “Well, she has since Monday.”

Catra grins widely, “That’s good to know.”

Adora rolls her eyes looking away as Glimmer laughs out, taking a sip of her beer, "I think I want to find some cider or a mixer or something. Beer is just gross."

"Then why are you drinking it?" Adora asks putting one hand on her hip, her other one still in Catra's hand.

"I thought I could like it again, but, no. Still gross." Glimmer sticks her tongue out.

"It was good to meet you guys." Catra says to the pair, "I thought I'd bring Adora back to you, just in case she wanders off or falls asleep on the couch."

"Can't you take me home?" Adora whines out as turns to her friends who look like they are still enjoying the party, "You guys stay. I've reached my limit for drinks and fun. And all I want to do is go home and sleep."

"Are you sure?" Bow asks, "We can head back if you want to go."

"No, it's fine." Adora reassures her friends, "You guys look like you're having fun. And Catra's heading off now anyway."

"You are?" Glimmer looks at the magicat, "It's still early…"

"Designated driver for Seahawk and his girl." Catra simply replies, "And… I better get going soon since they've already headed out." She turns to Adora, "Are you coming with me or staying here?"

"I wanna go with you." Adora declares with a big grin.

"Go on." Bow gently pushes the blonde out, "I've just run into a few people I haven't seen in ages. And Glimmer still hasn't got her buzz yet."

"Thanks guys." Adora hugs her friends before reaching her hand out to Catra, "Okay, I'm ready to go home."

Catra nods and takes Adora's hand and guides her outside to a car that's clearly not hers, since Seahawk and Mermista as making out against it. The latter pushes Seahawk away as soon as Catra comes into view, "Finally. Can we get going now?"

The magicat unlocks the fancy and very expensive car, Seahwawk and Mermista clambering inside quickly as Adora goes to sit in the front passenger's seat while Catra gets into the driver's seat, she turns to face the couple in the back seat, "Please refrain from fucking in the backseat while the car is in motion. I really don't need to die by ass to the back of my head because you guys don't have seatbelts on."

"Then drive us home faster, Catra." Mermista drawls in a challenging tone.

"Seatbelts." Catra repeats and the other woman groans out but complies, "Good. Now, let's get you guys home."

An hour later…

"Are you going to be alright in there by yourself?" Catra asks as she parks up in front of Adora's place.

"Do you want to come in?" Adora asks.

"I… I don't think that's a good idea." Cara replies with a sigh.

The blonde nods and slowly exits the car, "Thank you for taking me home, Catra."

"You're welcome, Adora." Catra keeps the engine running while she watches Adora round the vehicle so she's standing by the driver's window, the magicat winds it down thinking the blonde wants to talk some more, only to be met with soft lips against her cheek once more.

“Goodnight Catra.” Adora straightens back up, clearly pleased with the reaction from the magicat staring back at her in surprise, the blonde steps back, “Text me when you get home?”

Catra nods dumbly as she watches Adora walk to her front door, opening it and stepping inside. She touches her cheek and sighs with a grin, “Goodnight Adora.”

Monday midday

Catra’s phone rings, the magicat reaching out blindly for it as she tries to pause the video game she’s currently playing, eventually managing to get hold of it and presses the green button without looking at it, “Hello?”

“Catra!” Adora voice beams into the phone.

The magicat picking up the phone and giving it her full attention, “Hey Adora. What’s up?”

“Can you meet me tomorrow morning?” The blonde asks.

“Like… for breakfast?” Catra scratches her head.

The sound of Adora’s laugh has the magicat smiling, “Not exactly.”

“Okay…”

“I’ve got a meeting with Ms Weaver tomorrow morning.” Adora says and Catra can hear her biting her bottom lip as she says it, “Could you… meet me there?”

“For… support?” Catra asks a little confused, “Is everything okay? Is Weaver threatening you or something?”

“No, we’re just having a chat.” Adora replies vaguely, “So… can you meet me in the morning?”

“Did you need a lift?” Catra asks instead.

“I’ll just meet you there?” Adora asks back.

Catra frowns out, this conversation not making any sense as she succumbs, “What time?”

“My meeting is at 11am.” There’s a sound of someone talking in the background of wherever Adora is, the blonde seems to mutter something in response to a question in the background before going back to her conversation with Catra, “So… can you meet me there?”

“Why?”

“Just… please?” Adora breathes out.

Catra thinks about it for a moment, before sighing out, “Eleven, right?”

“Yes.”

“Okay, I’ll be there.” Catra replies, “But this is only because I want to be sure Weaver isn’t doing this to manipulate you or try something.”

“Thank you, Catra.” Adora says, “I’ll see you tomorrow! I can’t wait.”

The magicat laughs at hearing Adora’s voice sound genuinely happy, “Yeah, I’ll see you there.”

Horde Enterprises 11am

Catra walks into the main foyer of the place she used to work. The staff give her looks as she just stands by the door, waiting for Adora to show up. Her ears pick up the sound of footsteps coming towards her and she instantly groans out when she spots security

beelining their way towards her, a familiar supervisor not too far behind them with a sneer on their face as they stop just in front of the magicat.

“Excuse me.” The large, black suited security guard crosses his arms over his chest, “You need to leave. Now.”

“I’m not doing anything.” Catra argues, “Literally, I’m just standing here waiting for someone.”

“You’re trespassing. Get out.” Octavia growls out, “Or don’t. I’m going to enjoy throwing you out. Or rather, let security throw you out so I can film it and then show everyone what a dropkick you are.”

“Don’t bother.” The magicat shrugs off the threat, “I didn’t want to be here anyway.”

“Yeah? Then get the fuck out.” Her old supervisor points to the door and then pushes the magicat back towards the door, “Don’t your big dumb ear work? I said, get the fuck out.”

“Don’t touch me.” Catra growls back.

“Yeah? And what are you going to do about it? Huh?” The large woman goads, straightening up to full height to loom over the magicat, “You’re not going to do shit, because that’s exactly what you are. You’re a shit worker and just shit all around. If they had listened to me, you would have been kicked out after your first few days.”

Just as the magicat is about to retort, the security guard puts a hand on her shoulder and squeezes, “I think you need to leave. Now.” He says with another squeeze, “Or I will have to use force.”

“Get your hands off her!” Adora appears from an elevator door opening, Shadow Weaver stepping out after her, the blonde rushes out and pulls Catra further into the building, the blonde pushes herself in front, glancing over at the magicat and asking, “Are you alright?”

Catra nods and then asks, “What am I doing here, Adora?”

“You’ll see.” Adora gives her a tight smile and a wink as a few more people walk through the doors of Horde Enterprises, two of which Catra recognises, the blonde’s smile growing when she sees them and when she turns back to Catra, “Ready?”

“For?”

“You’ll see.” The blonde repeats as she grabs Catra by the hand and pulls her towards the small group of people, “Come on.”

“Hey! You can’t just come in here.” Octavia huffs out at the group that have just entered the foyer, “Who do you think you are?!”

Glimmer frowns at the large Horde woman, “Who are we?! Are you kidding me?! How can you not know who we are?!”

“Glimmer…” Bow puts his hand on her shoulder in an attempt to calm her down, “Take a breath.”

The sparkly girl closes her eyes and takes a deep breath, but the frown is still there before stomping her foot down petulantly, “No! It’s not helping!”

“Glimmer.” The taller woman behind her chastises, “That is not how you talk to people.” She looks to Octavia with a thin line of a smile on her face, “My daughter is very passionate.”

Octavia stares at the taller woman and just as she’s about to mouth off once more, another voice cuts in, “Angella and… company. To what do I owe this… visit?”

“I think it would be best if we spoke in private, Ms Weaver.” Angella replies.

“Very well.” Shadow Weaver replies as she gestures for Octavia to come over to her, “Octavia, show them to our conference room.”

“But…” Octavia starts to argue.

"I said, now." Shadow Weaver's voice stern.

"Yes, Ms Weaver." The large woman replies in a grunt as she turns to the group and then notices Catra with them, "Not you, Catra. Get out of here, you little shit."

"Octavia." Shadow Weaver growls out, "Enough of your nonsense and bring all of them to the conference room. Now."

"But…"

"She's coming with us." Angella simply says.

The large woman looks to Shadow Weaver once more, the TDSW just waves her off, Octavia grumbles to the group, "Follow me."

Inside the conference room…

"What am I doing here?" Catra whispers to Adora as Angella takes a seat at the large conference table.

Angella gestures to Catra, "Come, sit down."

"No, I think I'm okay standing." Catra says as she leans back against the far wall, out of sight and hopefully out of the firing line even though she doesn't work there anymore, "Who are all these people and why are they here?"

Adora leans on the wall next to Catra, "That's Angella and her security team. And you already know Bow and Glimmer, my best friends. They also work with me. Well, Glimmer is Angella's daughter and Bow is her boyfriend…"

"Okay… and why are they here?" Catra asks just as Shadow Weaver, Octavia, Hordak and a few other Horde Enterprises

people arrive, taking up the rest of the seats around the conference room as the magicat looks around the room.

Angella clears her throat loudly, drawing the attention of the room to her, “Good morning, everyone. Thank you all for coming.”

Shadow Weaver breathes in loudly and then says, “To what do we owe your presence today? We are very busy and don’t have time for this interruption.”

“From what I hear, a lot of your projects are currently behind or not started at all.” Angella starts to say, “Not to mention there are a lot of unhappy clients that have already paid and yet to see any progress on the projects you have already taken their money for.”

“As you are well aware, it takes time for such large projects to come online and subsequently get off the ground…” Shadow Weaver starts to say.

Angella cuts her off, “On top of that, there seems to a systemic abuse of power from the top of the ladder. But that is not what I’m here for.”

“Then what are you here for.” Hordak says irately, “You are wasting my time.”

The stern look on Angella’s face is more than enough to shut the Horde representatives up, “You’ve been given more than enough time and money to complete several projects, yet 5% has barely been done.”

“Frankly, we are fed up.” Glimmer cuts in with a satisfied smirk, “And we have bought out this business.”

“You… you what?” Hordak says genuinely shocked, “That is not possible.”

“It is totally possible.” Glimmer replies with snark, “Perhaps you should have spoken to your accounting people.”

“It is not possible without my say so.” Hordak corrects, “I am the CEO of this company and as such have the final say.”

“False.” Glimmer says before Angella puts her hand up to stop her daughter from speaking further.

“You might be the CEO, but you are only the CEO as long as the board keeps you on.” Angella explains, “And fortunately for me, the Horde board is easily bought out. And as of today, Bright Moon Industrial now owns this building along with all the debts and projects that have already been contracted as a sign of good will to our new clients contracts to ensure that what has already been promised will be completed and delivered in full and within reasonable time.”

Hordak stands up abruptly, “You can’t do this. This is *my* company.”

Catra looks around the room stunned at what she’s hearing, not sure how she even fits in this room or why Adora has insisted she stay.

Angella smiles, “There will be many changes coming. We will be announcing those changes in due course.”

Hordak shakes his head, “This is ridiculous. Get out of my building.”

“This is my building now.” Angella simply says, “And please keep your voice down. We are trying to be civil after all.”

“And in regard to being civil, what will happen to our many workers?” Shadow Weaver asks through gritted teeth, “Surely, you will still need our expertise…”

“That is true.” Angella agrees with the same serene smile as she adds, “Hordak will stay on as lead engineer to work alongside or chief engineer, Entrapta. That is if he would like to take on that position.”

“Entrapta?” Hordak sits back down upon hearing that name, “I haven’t seen her in such a long time…”

“She has recommended that you stay and assist with operations.” Glimmer informs him, “She seems to think you have invaluable insight that could be helpful for future projects.”

There’s a small smile on Hordak’s lips when he thinks about Entrpata before he clears his throat, “Will I still hold my position as CEO?”

“In a way.” Angella replies, “We will trial you for 3 months and see if anything changes and then go from there.”

He seems to find that agreeable, nodding once to accept the deal.

“You are dismissed, Hordak.” Angella tells, “Entrapta will meet up with you tomorrow to go through… things.”

“Of course.” Hordak replies and walks out of the room with his direct Horde representatives, there’s a sense of satisfaction in the way he walks out of the room.

“What about me?” Octavia asks, putting on her most sincere smile she can muster.

“You?” Angella asks with a raised eyebrow and Octavia nods trying to seem innocent in this situation, “Well, I had a few of my trusted workers go undercover to work here to see what the culture is like and, honestly, the reports I got back from a few of them were less than ideal.”

“What does that mean?” Octavia asks looking between Angella and Adora, “I barely even worked with the blondie!”

Keeping calm, Angella continues on, “Yes. That is very true. You barely did work with her.”

Octavia relaxes upon hearing that, thinking she’s off the hook.

“Adora, please come over and read out report about your week here at Horde Enterprises.” Angella waves the blonde over.

Catra watches Adora walk over to stand next to Angella’s chair, clearing her throat, “Thank you, Angella.” The tall woman gestures for her to continue, “My week with Horde Enterprises was… eye opening. Ms Weaver was very accommodating in offering to take me to site and even bringing me out to lunch.”

“Of course, Adora.” Shadow Weaver preens at the so far glowing report, but that is short lived as Adora continues.

“Unfortunately, my favouritism aside, though appreciated, her management of her supervisor and her workers was less than idea.” Adora says with a frown as she looks down at the table, avoiding eye contact with Shadow Weaver, “Overlooking good workers for lazy and incompetent supervisors that were never on site when they were supposed to.”

“I was so there!” Octavia argues loudly, getting to her feet angrily at the accurate accusations.

“Only because I made a phone call to Ms Weaver when you hadn’t shown up to site and then was still 2hrs late.” Adora recalls, “Not to mention the way you treat your workers on site is appalling.”

“You have no proof of that.” Octavia protests.

“I do. The crew will back me up on this.” Adora points out.

“Octavia’s actions are not of my doing.” Shadow Weaver looks to distance herself from Octavia, “From what I have observed, she has always been a good worker and a good supervisor. If anything, I feel just as… manipulated as you do.”

Catra balls her hands into fists hearing the cop out excuse Shadow Weaver is giving, doing her best not to say something she’ll regret.

“That’s not true.” Adora says shaking her head, “You knew exactly how she works to the point where you just stopped caring whether she was doing the job or not.”

“You don’t know what you’re talking about, Adora.” Shadow Weaver simply says, trying not to grit her teeth as she says it, “You were only with us for a week. You couldn’t possibly know how Octavia or myself or even this organisation works.”

The blonde shakes her head again, “You had me shadow a labourer because your supervisor wasn’t there most of the time.” Adora says to the room, “I honestly thought I wouldn’t learn much from such an entry level worker, but, stars, I was very surprised.”

“Of course you were.” Shadow Weaver tries to take the compliment, “Our entry level workers are highly skilled.”

“Yes, she is.” Adora replies glancing over at Catra, “But that is not because of you.”

The TDSW makes an unhappy noise and then scoffs but doesn’t say anything else.

“You fired a very good worker out of spite.” Adora says and Angella just raises an eyebrow at Shadow Weaver as Adora continues, “You fired the one worker on your team that worked so hard for very little praise or renumeration. You fired her because she helped out another coworker.”

“If you are talking about Catra, she had never cleared Scorpia’s leave days with either myself or Octavia. Clearly a fireable offense.” Shadow Weaver tires to rationalise.

“And that may have been the case.” Adora sighs much to Catra’s chagrin, the blonde looks at the magicat with a tight smile, “But, she had those shifts covered. Did she not?”

“That is not the point, Adora.” Shadow Weaver tries to stamp down her authority, “She doesn’t have the authority to grant leave. She is not a supervisor.”

“Would you have approved that leave?” Angella interrupts, surprising Shadow Weaver and Octavia.

“Of course.” Shadow Weaver lies, “As long as we were given ample time to get coverage organised.”

This time Catra scoffs, her hands still balled into fists as she shoves them into her pockets so no one can see the frustration in her body.

“Ah, yes.” Adora hums and then moves to the computer, “Can someone log me in please?”

“Why?” Octavia asks, making no moves to assist.

“I would like to show the room an email.” Adora replies vaguely, “So, please get this set up for me?”

Begrudgingly, Octavia gets up and turns on the projector and then logs into the computer before going back to her chair and lounging out on it as Adora quickly taps on the keyboard and logs into her email, pulling up the email she had spoke about earlier as Shadow Weaver speaks, sounding bored, “What is this?”

“An email trail from Scorpia.” Adora uses the mouse to highlight the corresponding evidence, “This is dated 3 months ago.”

“How did you get this?” Shadow Weaver frowns, “This is an invasion of privacy.”

“Not if she voluntarily passes it on to me.” Adora replies and then continues on, “As I was saying, this is dated 3 months ago when she had requested a few days off to deal with an electrical problem at her home. And as you’ll also note, there is no reply. Not from anyone.”

“We must have missed this.” Shadow Weaver dismisses the email, “It happens when things get busy…”

“Did you also miss the 5 other requests after that in the space to 2 weeks too?” Adora asks, the cursor highlighting who the requests were sent to, “This was sent to Ms Weaver, Octavia and the general work email, she had even sent one company wide and was still met with silence.”

“She should not have been sending out company wide emails.” Octavia snarks out.

“That is not the point.” Adora replies curtly, “The point is, she had requested leave 3 months ago. That’s more than enough time to find cover. She even found cover for those shifts she would miss and yet, no response from management. So, tell me again why you had Catra fired when cover had already been organised and the work still completed?”

“It is not the role of a labourer to approve or cover leave.” Shadow Weaver says.

“But you weren’t doing it. Nor were you, Octavia.” Adora shakes her head.

“If this is about Catra and your obvious infatuation with the magicat, then I think you are making a very big mistake, Adora.” Shadow Weaver warns.

“No, you miscalculated Catra’s worth.” Adora tries not to snap back, “In my one week working for Horde Enterprises, the only person that worked hard and cared about the jobs, the workers and safety was Catra.”

“I find that hard to believe.” Octavia rolls her eyes, “That little runt doesn’t do shit.”

“Are you sure about that?” Glimmer pipes up as she walks over with Bow, the latter leaning over and then typing something in and bringing up a few graphs showing productivity and projects from the last 2 years that H.E had completed or worked on.

“What is this?” Octavia narrows her eyes at the information while Shadow Weaver sits back and pretends not to care.

“It’s data Entrapta has collected from the last 5 years.” Glimmer replies, “It’s public information since you have to post the data every 6 months for your shareholders.”

“Speaking of shareholders…” Shadow Weaver sees an opening.

“We hold majority of shares.” Angella replies with an air of confidence, making Shadow Weaver huff out, “Go on, Glimmer.”

“Anyway, as I was saying, this graph shows how many projects have been completed versus how many projects that were completed but had to be revisited due to substandard work.” Glimmer explains pointing the graph, “As you can see, since Catra starting, the number of completed projects has increased and the number of fu-, ahem, number of projects needing to be revisited decreased. This is not a coincidence.”

“That doesn’t mean that Catra was the main contributor to it.” Shadow Weaver dismisses the thought of the magicat being useful, “We have hired numerous people in that space. Very skilled and efficient people that would have affected that chart.”

“True.” Bow nods, “Except, those new hires never last long enough. They were generally promoted to other areas that weren’t directly involved with the construction of these projects. And as you can see from the graphs, this is purely to do with the construction side of things and not anything else.”

“This is completely baseless. I was well within my right to fire her.” Shadow Weaver says smugly, “She wasn’t up to standard.”

“I disagree.” Adora argues, “But this is not about Catra.”

“Adora is correct. This is not about Catra.” Angella nods to the blonde, “This is about whether or not you two fit in with our vision moving forward.”

“My team has been the most profitable for years.” Shadow Weaver gloats, “If not for my team, this company would not be profitable at all.”

“Actually, about that.” Angella smiles, “I had my people go through your books and suffice to say I was extremely surprised to see one name constantly on every project from 2 years ago. And do you know who’s name that was?”

Shadow Weaver waves her hand in the air with a ‘I don’t care’ attitude as she waits for Angella to just tell her.

“That one name was Catra.” Angella finally finishes, “And from what Adora has reported back, she seems to have taken most if not all of the workload for most sites.”

“That’s bullshit.” Octavia huffs out, “She doesn’t do everything.”

“I disagree.” Adora repeats again from earlier, “Because she does.”

“Whatever.” Octavia grunts out.

“I had to practically force her to stop working even after the job was completed.” Adora starts, “She’s organised everything from crew to plant equipment all the while ensuring she’s got the right drawings, crane requirements and inspectors and inspections in place to get her sites certified.”

“Like what exactly?” Shadow Weaver asks, genuinely interested, “What certificates are you talking about?”

“Well, for one, she made sure there was someone out to do the testing for the concrete mix on my first day.” Adora replies, “And then making sure the crane driver had the right sized machine for the job as well as was qualified to do the rigging.” She turns to Shadow Weaver, “Why would you schedule me to work a crane shift that required rope access with Catra, when you knew I didn’t have any of those qualifications to start with?”

“I didn’t schedule you for that shift, Adora.” Shadow Weaver tries to dodge responsibility, “I am not in charge of scheduling, the supervisor is in charge of that.”

“Wait a minute! What!?” The betrayal in Octavia’s voice evident as she’s thrown under the bus by her boss, “No. No way! I am not in charge of that!”

“Enough!” Angella raises her voice, “Look its doesn’t matter who’s fault it is. The point is that it wasn’t picked up on. And quite frankly I’ve had enough.”

Shadow Weaver turns her head, “Enough?”

“Yes.” Angella nods with a sigh, “Ms Weaver and Octavia, your services are no longer required moving forward when Bright Moon Industrial takes over. Please turn in any keys or Horde equipment and property and vacate the premises. You will receive your final pay checks by the end of the week.” She stares at the pair and then adds, “That is all. You may leave now.”

“Wait, no!” Octavia shouts out, “This is bullshit! You can’t fire me!”

“I believe she can and she has.” Glimmer snorts out a laugh, “Get out of our building or security will escort you out.”

The pair stand up abruptly before security makes any moves towards them, Angella calmly doing the same as she simply says, “Catra. Can you come forward please?”

“Why?” The magicat knows she’s being defensive, but she can’t help it when her two former bosses are about to get thrown out of the building, that’s even despite all the positive comments she’s heard from Adora about the magicat.

Angella turns her head and easily reads the magicat’s thoughts, a soft smile on her lips, “You are not in any trouble, Catra. I assure you of this.”

“Why?” Catra repeats once more, though the looks she gets from around the room make her feel dumb for doing so, “I don’t even work here anymore.”

“Okay.” Angella relents and lets the magicat stay where she is, the tall, slender and kind looking woman nods to her, “I would like to offer you a new position.”

“Huh?” Catra replies as dumb as she feels.

“After deliberations with the Bright Moon Industrial board and management, we would like to offer you a position to work for us moving forward.” Angella explains, “I have been monitoring certain staff members from the Horde since our acquisition and one name constantly comes up. Your name.”

“And what exactly do you want me to do?” Catra asks cautiously, “I’m just a shit kicker…”

Adora snorts out a laugh at the way Catra speaks to Angella, she grimaces when Glimmer elbows her in the side and she quickly sputters out an apology, “Sorry… sorry… go on…”

“As I was saying, your name kept constantly coming up.” Angella continues, “We have heard very positive things about you, your work ethic and your leadership. Including those that came from Adora. It was quite… refreshing to hear and also quite a surprise.”

“I doubt those positive things came from within the Horde.” Catra scoffs out.

“That’s not true.” Adora pipes up, “A lot of your crew have nothing but good things to say about you. And I know you probably didn’t notice, but they like working for you. They all call you boss, for stars sakes!”

The magicat’s ears twitch, confused at what she’s hearing, “Yeah, but that’s only because I open up the site for them and get them to sign in and all that junk.”

“Catra.” Angella shakes her head, “Tell me, what was your title before you were let go?”

“Labourer.”

“But that wasn’t all that you did though, was it?” Angella probes a little more and then looks over to Shadow Weaver and Octavia, “Catra, like I was saying, I would like to offer you a new position with Bright Moon Industrial. Perhaps even help with the transition of other key staff from Horde to Bright Moon.”

“Why me?” Catra asks with wide and unbelieving eyes.

“For fuck’s sakes, we’ve already gone through this!” Glimmer grunts out, “Just say yes and then we can go already.”

All eyes go to Catra, the magicat stands there still completely stunned at the change of events.

“Angella.” Shadow Weaver’s voice breaks the momentary silence, “I’m not sure who has fed you all these *lies,* but let me assure you that you do not want Catra in any type of leadership roles.”

“She’s right.” Octavia agrees, crossing her arms over her chest and nodding, “She’s lazy, incompetent and wastes a lot of time and money unnecessarily. I mean, look at the books!”

“We have looked at the books.” Angella addresses the pair, “And it seems that the only person that wasn’t ‘cooking’ them, was Catra. You two however, the same can not be said. And don’t try to deny it, we have enough evidence to prove that.”

“But if I may…” Shadow Weaver tries again.

“No, we’ve heard enough from you and your supervisor.” Angella puts an abrupt end to the conversation, “You two are no longer staff members of this organisation as of now or before whenever I initially said it. You will receive your final paycheck by the end of the week. Now, if you don’t mind, since you are no longer a part of this organisation, clear out any personal items from your

workstations and leave. My guards will escort you until such times as you leave these premises."

"Wait! I need this job!" Octavia shouts out, slamming her hands on the table, "You can't just fire us. That's, that's… unfair dismissal!"

"I think not." Angella sighs as she clicks her fingers and Bow brings up a file onto the screen, "Your many indiscretions are well documented as you can see on the screen. Let me remind you that some of those are also illegal and as such if you do not leave now, we will report it to the authorities and let me tell you, being let go is a far less… severe punishment."

Octavia instantly frowns but then realisation hits her and she puts her arms up in surrender, "Whatever. Fuck this place." She storms out of the room, two of Angella's guards quickly going after her.

Shadow Weaver takes a in a deep breath and then without saying anything, turns and walks out the door, another two of Angella's guards following her closely.

Adora walks over to Catra, "So?"

"Uh…" Catra says looking into Adora's hopeful eyes, "I-I um, I think I need to think about this."

"Of course." Adora nods with a smile.

Catra furrows her brows, "Wait, what about the other people? Like Scorpia? Or Lonnie and the rest of them?"

"Entrapta has a list of names." Bow walks over to the pair, "But her list is completely data driven and maybe biased."

"Okay…" Catra say with uncertainty, "What does that mean?"

"Well, it'd be nice if you could have a look at that list and let us know who shouldn't be on there." Bow replies with a smile, "I

mean, you don't have to, but it'd be good to have someone on the inside that knows these people on a personal level."

"I can have a look at that list." Catra offers.

"What about what Angella said?" Adora asks quietly as all eyes go back to the magicat once more.

Catra swallows down as she looks past Adora and over at Angella, "Can I think about it?"

"Of course." Angella nods, a warm smile on her face, "We can send through the job description to you to peruse if you'd like as well."

"What position are you offering me exactly?" Catra asks.

"It's a sort of… hybrid position." Angella replies vaguely, "But you'll be essentially a supervisor or manager, depending on what role you take up."

"You're offering me a role that you don't even know what it is?" The magicat surmises confused, "How exactly would you send me through a job description for something like that."

"I'm sure we can figure something out." Angella brushes Catra's concerns off, "And then we can discuss other things like salary and titles." She looks at the time and then smiles once more, "Adora will pass you my contact information once you have thought it over. In the meantime, we will need to get back to prepare for another meeting regarding the announcement of this takeover. Talk soon."

Catra watches as Angella and the rest of her people leave the room, only her and Adora stay behind. The blonde standing in front of Catra with a smile on her face, "This is so exciting!"

The magicat chuckles awkwardly, rubbing the back of her head, "Oh, yeah, I guess it is."

“What’s wrong?” Adora’s face drops slightly in concern, “Isn’t this what you wanted?”

“I honestly have no idea what I want, princess.” Catra drops her hands to her sides, “Well, I do know what I want. I just don’t know what I want… job-wise.”

“Oh.” Adora’s face, a mix of surprise and happiness, “Okay, what do you want… not job-wise?”

Catra looks up, “Well, it’s kind of obvious, isn’t it?”

Adora shakes her head and feigns innocent, “I’m very oblivious.”

The magicat chuckles and it brings a smile to Adora’s face, “You know what I want. Even you aren’t that oblivious.” Catra sighs, “But if I agree to work for Bright Moon… then this,” she gestures between them, “This can’t happen. It just wouldn’t be professional.”

“But we wouldn’t be working together, Catra.” Adora rolls her eyes, “We wouldn’t even be in the same department. It’d be like dating between an accountant and someone in operations. Totally different sectors and there’s nothing wrong with that.”

“I guess…” Catra breathes out, “But… I still kind of want to think about it. Maybe even sleep on it.”

Adora nods, “Okay.” The blonde grabs Catra’s hands, “But don’t think I’ve forgotten about our date once your employed again.”

The magicat laughs, “Of course I won’t.”

“So…” Adora moves in closer into Catra’s space.

“Hm?” The magicat hums back with a smirk on her face as she watches the blonde lick her lips.

“Hey, Catra! I heard the good news!” Scorpia bursts into the conference room as Adora and Catra quickly break apart in

surprise, the magicat's hands still on Adora's hips as her scorpini friends looks on apologetically, "Oh, oops! Sorry! I'll come back later…" and as she shuts the door, Scorpia calls out, "Congratulations!"

Adora quickly leans back in and presses a kiss on Catra's cheek, "Got plans for the rest of the day?"

"Nope. You?" Catra says.

Adora shakes her head, "I've been given the rest of the week off."

"Cool." Catra nods as they stand just staring at each other, "Do you need a ride home?"

"Stars, I thought you'd never ask!" Adora breathes out relived as Catra laughs.

"Okay, well, let's go then." Catra tugs on Adora's hand and drags her out, "Since I'm still technically trespassing right now."

2 weeks later…

"Nice work crew." Catra says to the crew and then pats Slick on the back, "You're still the best form worker I know, Slick."

"Too easy, boss." He laughs as he slaps her on the back in return, "Next time make it harder."

"No way. I'm not purposely doing that." Catra replies with a shake of the head, "Besides, why mess with the tried and true ways, right? If it's not broke, why fix it?"

"Right." He grins as the rest of the crew follow the pair to the site office.

“Sign off and you can head off.” Catra announces to the crew, “Also, I know it’s Friday night and it’s been a fairly big week so try not to go too hard as we’ve got an early start come Monday. Just look after each other and try to drink responsibly or whatever.”

The crew all groan playfully as they all sign off, Lonnie comes back behind the magicat and pats Catra on the shoulder, “Come out for drinks, boss. You’ve earned it. Plus we haven’t even properly celebrated yet.”

Just as Catra is about to answer, a familiar blonde walks in and takes the words out of the magicat’s mouth, waving happily at her, “Hey, Adora.”

“Hi. Are you ready?” Adora asks as she smiles at the magicat, “Hey Lonnie.”

“Hey. Oh...” Lonnie looks between the pair before patting Catra on the back once more, “Maybe next Friday?”

“Uh, yeah, sure Lon.” Catra replies without taking her eyes off the blonde, looking absolutely stunning in a red dress and her hair down, “I’ll see you guys on Monday.”

“Have fun, boss. It was good to see you again, Adora. Don’t be a stranger.” Lonnie grins, waving to the pair as she exits the site office and heading back to the rest of the crew, “Boss is busy tonight! Drinks! Let’s go! Whoop!”

Catra laughs at her crew’s antics as she signs off on the all the paperwork and files them away, looking up at Adora, “I’ve just got to change and then we’re all good to go.” She looks the blonde up and down, “You look amazing.”

“Thanks.” Adora blushes from the compliment, “Thought I’d try to look nice for wherever we’re going tonight.”

“How’d you get here?” Catra asks as she pats her pockets to check she’s got everything.

“Glimmer dropped me off.” Adora replies, “She won’t shut up about the old Horde employees trying to weasel their way back into the building.”

“Seems about right.” Catra shrugs, “I’m guessing they still want their old jobs back.”

“Definitely.” Adora breathes out, “I had to get restraining orders against the pair of them because it was bordering on harassment.”

“Can’t take a hint, can they?” Catra laughs.

“No. Definitely not.” Adora smiles with a shake of her head, “Angella’s got security keeping an eye out for them just in case they try something.”

“Well, I can’t say I feel bad for them.” Catra says, “But hopefully they find some sort of purpose in life apart from making other people feel like shit.”

“I’ve got a feeling they’ll be delving into illegal activities soon enough.” Adora suggests and it makes the magicat laugh, “What?! They totally are the type to though!”

“Yeah, they are.” Catra replies, “Just, watch your back.”

“You too.” Adora returns before taking in a breath, “Okay, are you ready to get going?”

“I’ve just got to get changed first.” Catra grins, “Can’t be looking too shabby when my date is looking like a fucking supermodel.”

Adora snorts out a laugh, “What are you wearing?”

“Hopefully nothing by the end of the night.” Catra winks at the blonde, chuckling at the reaction from Adora and her reddening cheeks as she adds, “And hopefully you’ll be matching me in that department.”

“Stars…” Adora breathes out, rolling her eyes as well, “You know that’s not what I meant.”

“I know.” Catra laughs, “My suit is in my ute. I’ll be right back.”

“Catra wait!” Adora grabs Catra by the wrist.

And as the magicat pauses, she pulls Adora into her and presses her lips on the blonde’s, the kiss taken Adora by surprise but once she’s over the shock, she kisses Catra back with fervour.

“Mm… what was that for?” Adora asks, her eyes still closed and feeling a little lightheaded.

“I’m employed again.” Catra simply replies as she leans back in for another kiss, “And I don’t have to feel conflicted about doing this all night and as much as possible.”

Adora laughs, “You know you didn’t have to start up your own crewing company just so we can date, right?”

“Sure, I did. Can’t be dating coworkers and having gossip circling around about how I slept my way to the top…” Catra grins, “Besides, I’m sick of working for other people.”

“Well, now you’re the boss. Boss.” Adora quirks an eyebrow up and then presses a kiss on Catra’s cheek, “Totally suits you, boss.”

Catra laughs, “Well, it didn’t feel right being called boss unless I really am the boss. Right?”

Adora nods, “So… if we aren’t working together…”

“Mm…” Catra leans back in for another kiss, “Dating is only the start, princess… there are so many more things I want to do with you that involves more kissing… definitely touching and…”

“Oh, stars…” Adora breathes out as she kisses Catra until they are both out of breath.

End Notes

Ah, you've got to the end!
Thanks for reading!
This took a lot longer than what I thought it would... but I couldn't leave it unfinished.
I hope you enjoyed it as much as I enjoyed writing this.
and now I'm going to go back to my other two fics...

Kudos and comments are always appreciated. 🥰
Though, no pressure for either.

I'm on tumblr - @masternoveller

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!